

Statements, Functions and Program Organization

CSC 230 : C and Software Tools

NC State Department of Computer
Science

Topics for Today

- Flow-of-control
- Functions, Memory and Storage Class
- Multi-file programs
 - Global variable and function declaration
 - Header files
 - Compile and link

Flow-of-Control Statements

- C shares most flow-of-control statements with Java
- But, there are some differences.

```
for ( int i = 0; i < 25; i++ ) {  
    ...  
}
```

```
if ( x < 25 ) {  
    ...  
} else {  
    ...  
}
```

```
do {  
    ...  
} while ( !done );
```

```
while ( i != 0 ) {  
    ...  
}
```

```
switch ( code ) {  
    case 0:  
        ...;  
        break;  
    case 1:  
        ...;  
        break;  
    default:  
        ...;  
}
```

Constant Expressions

- In some places, C requires a value that can be determined at compile time
 - e.g., in the cases of a switch statement.
 - And a bunch of other places we'll talk about later
- C will let you use an expression here
 - But **the compiler** must be able to determine the value of the expression.
 - So, it can't depend on execution-time behavior
 - These are called *constant expressions*

Constant Expressions

- The compiler will reject our code if we put some other expression where a constant expression is required.

```
int three = 3;

switch ( val ) {

  case 0: // trivial
    val += 1;
    break;

  case 2 / 2: // fine
    val -= 1;
    break;

  case 25/7%2 + 19 - 6*3: // OK
    val *= 2;
    break;

  case three: // Nope
    break;

}
```

Constant Expressions

- Why?
- This is what the compiler will try to create
 - It's a jump table
 - With each index pointing to a case.

0	—
1	—
2	—

```
int three = 3;

switch ( val ) {

  case 0:
    val += 1;
    break;

  case 2 / 2:
    val -= 1;
    break;

  case 25/7%2 + 9 - 6*3:
    val *= 2;
    break;

}
```

Changing the Flow of Control

I'm probably
evil 😊

- `break`, `continue` and `goto` let us alter the normal flow of control.
- Here's a nested loop with obvious flow-of control

```
int val = 0;
for ( int i = 0; i < 10; i++ ) {
    for ( int j = 0; j < 10; j++ ) {
        printf( "%2d ", val );
        val += 1;
    }
    printf( "\n" );
}
```

outputs

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29
30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39
40	41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49
50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59
60	61	62	63	64	65	66	67	68	69
70	71	72	73	74	75	76	77	78	79
80	81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89
90	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99

Changing the Flow of Control

- `continue` lets us skip the rest of the innermost loop's current iteration.

```
int val = 0;
for ( int i = 0; i < 10; i++ ) {
    for ( int j = 0; j < 10; j++ ) {
        printf( "%2d ", val );
        if ( j > i )
            continue;
        val += 1;
    }
    printf( "\n" );
}
```

outputs

0	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
1	2	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
3	4	5	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
6	7	8	9	10	10	10	10	10	10
10	11	12	13	14	15	15	15	15	15
15	16	17	18	19	20	21	21	21	21
21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	28	28
28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	36
36	37	38	39	40	41	42	43	44	45
45	46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54

Skip the increment when j is large enough.

Changing the Flow of Control

- `break` lets us bail out of the innermost loop early (and we need it for the switch statement)

```
int val = 0;
for ( int i = 0; i < 10; i++ ) {
    for ( int j = 0; j < 10; j++ ) {
        printf( "%2d ", val );
        if ( j > i )
            break;
        val += 1;
    }
    printf( "\n" );
}
```

outputs

0	1								
1	2	3							
3	4	5	6						
6	7	8	9	10					
10	11	12	13	14	15				
15	16	17	18	19	20	21			
21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28		
28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	
36	37	38	39	40	41	42	43	44	45
45	46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54

Exit the inner loop when j is big enough.

- Unlike Java, C doesn't have a labeled break.

Changing the Flow of Control

- But, that's OK, ... err ... we have `goto`
- We can put a *label* before any statement in a function.

`myLabel:`

- Then, we can jump to that label when we need to.

`goto myLabel;`

- We can even jump in and out of loops.

Changing the Flow of Control

- With `goto`, we can jump out of loops of any depth

```
int val = 0;
for ( int i = 0; i < 10; i++ ) {
    for ( int j = 0; j < 10; j++ ) {
        printf( "%2d ", val );
        if ( val >= 55 )
            goto done;
        val += 1;
    }
    printf( "\n" );
}
done:
```

This is a destination for a goto.

This says jump to the done label right now.

outputs

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29
30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39
40	41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49
50	51	52	53	54	55				

Exit both loops when val is large enough.

Changing the Flow of Control

- With goto, we don't need any structured flow of control statements at all.
 - But, then we have no ... well ... structure.

```
val = 0;
int i = 0;
outer_top:
  if ( i >= 10 )
    goto finished;
  int j = 0;
  inner_top:
    if ( j >= 10 )
      goto done_2;
    printf( "%2d ", val );
    val += 1;
    j++;
    goto inner_top;
done_2:
  printf( "\n" );
  i++;
  goto outer_top;
finished:
```

outputs

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29
30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39
40	41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49
50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59
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70	71	72	73	74	75	76	77	78	79
80	81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89
90	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99

Nested
looping with
just goto.

Yuck. ... but this is how
loops are implemented
at the machine level.

Labels and Scope

- Labels used by goto don't obey block-structured scoping rules.
- You can goto a label that hasn't occurred yet.
- You can goto a label in a more deeply nested block.
- But, you can't goto a label in another function.

```
int bake( int t ) {  
    while ( true ) {  
        printf( "%d\n", t++ );  
        if ( t > 250 )  
            goto done;  
    }  
done:    return t;  
}  
  
void broil( int limit ) {  
    goto inside;  
    for ( int t = 0; t < limit; t++ ) {  
        inside:    printf( "%d\n", t );  
        goto done;  
    }  
done:    return;  
}
```

The diagram illustrates the behavior of the goto statement within a function. Red arrows show jumps from 'goto done;' in the 'bake' function to the 'done:' label, and from 'goto inside;' and 'goto done;' in the 'broil' function to their respective labels. This demonstrates that goto can jump to labels that have not yet occurred or are in more deeply nested blocks, as long as they are within the same function.

Labels and Scope

- Labels used by goto don't obey block-structured scoping rules.
- You can goto a label that hasn't occurred yet.
- You can goto a label in a more deeply nested block.
- But, you can't goto a label in another function.

```
int bake( int t ) {  
    while ( true ) {  
        printf( "%d\n", t++ );  
        if ( t > 250 )  
            goto done;  
    }  
    done:  
    return t;  
}  
  
void broil( int limit ) {  
    goto inside;  
    for ( int t = 0; t < limit; t++ ) {  
        inside:  
        printf( "%d\n", t );  
        goto done;  
    }  
    done:  
    return;  
}
```

I wonder
what value t
will have ...

... no way of
knowing.

Using and Not Using goto

- You should avoid using goto.
 - It makes it more difficult to understand loops.
 - You have to read the entire loop to see where it may terminate.
 - Maybe a reason to also avoid break & continue.
- Exceptions?
 - In some cases, it can simplify error handling.
 - In some cases, it can give you better performance.

```
if ( ... ) {  
    for ( ... ) {  
        while ( ... ) {  
            if ( ... ) {  
                ...;  
                if ( disaster )  
                    goto cleanup;  
                ...;  
            }  
        }  
    }  
}  
  
cleanup:  
    /** Clean up partial computation  
    and return */
```

Security Sidebar: “goto fail”

- iOS 7.0.6 used the following code to verify SSL messages
- If third SHA1 update operation has no error (err == 0)
 - The marked line jumps to code that returns “verified” if err == 0
 - Skips the actual sslRawVerify() method

```
. . .
hashOut.data = hashes + SSL_MD5_DIGEST_LEN;
hashOut.length = SSL_SHA1_DIGEST_LEN;
if ((err = SSLFreeBuffer(&hashCtx)) != 0)
    goto fail;
if ((err = ReadyHash(&SSLHashSHA1, &hashCtx)) != 0)
    goto fail;
if ((err = SSLHashSHA1.update(&hashCtx, &clientRandom)) != 0)
    goto fail;
if ((err = SSLHashSHA1.update(&hashCtx, &serverRandom)) != 0)
    goto fail;
if ((err = SSLHashSHA1.update(&hashCtx, &signedParams)) != 0)
    goto fail;
    goto fail; /* MISTAKE! THIS LINE SHOULD NOT BE HERE */
if ((err = SSLHashSHA1.final(&hashCtx, &hashOut)) != 0)
    goto fail;

err = sslRawVerify(...);
. . .
```


Side Effects

- Other than just computing a value, expressions can have side effects.
 - Maybe you use post/pre increment/decrement
 - Maybe you call a function that
 - Reads some input
 - Changes some global variables
- Expressions with side effects can be tricky.
- Don't believe me? Just watch.

Expression Evaluation Order

- The C standard leaves some details of expression evaluation up to the compiler
 - Why? Maybe the compiler can write faster code if we give it some flexibility.
- What if part of an expression has side effects?

```
a = 2;  
b = ++a + a;
```

```
x = 1;  
b = x-- && x;
```

Will this be 1 or 2?

```
a = 2;  
b = a * a + a-- + --a + a / a;
```

Could this be a divide-by-zero?

```
a = 2;  
b = 3;  
c = f( &a ) + g( &b ) + h( &a, &b );
```

Could f() and g() change these before I get them?

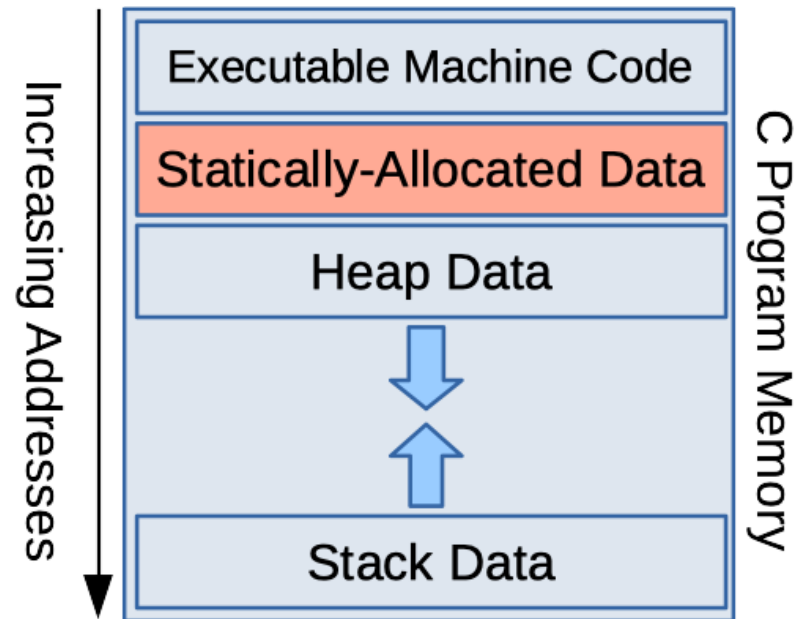
Evaluation Order

- C defines a surprisingly small number of *sequence points*
 - Places where know side effects to the left will occur before evaluation continues
- Here they are:
 - statement termination ;
 - closing parenthesis in a condition evaluation)
 - the following operators:
a && b a || b a ? b : c a , b
 - after evaluation of all arguments to a function call
 - after returning a value from a function
- In general, avoid cases where this matters
 - Don't mix side effects with multiple evaluations in the same expression.

But not between
function
parameters.

Storage Class

- A variable's *storage class* determines
 - Its lifetime
 - Where it's allocated
 - How it's initialized
- Global variables have *static storage* class.



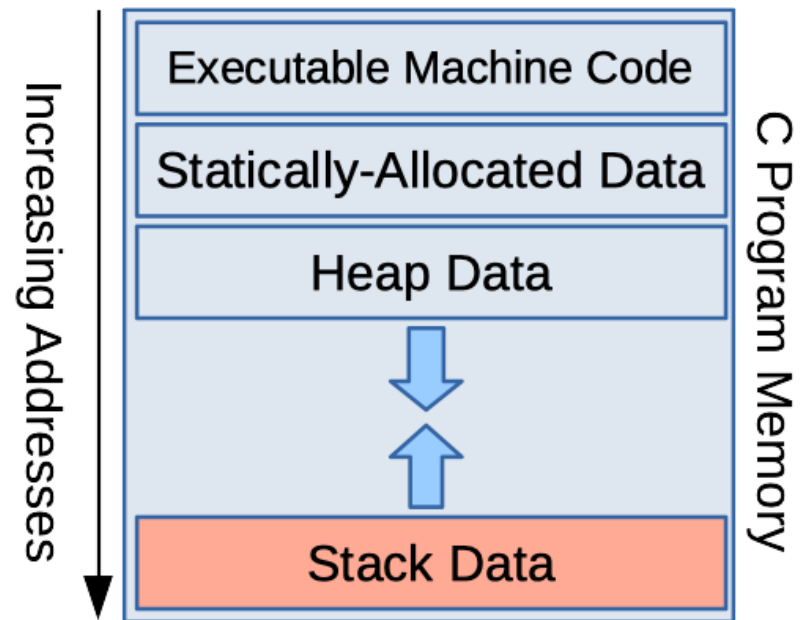
Static/Global Variable Initialization

- Variables with static allocation (e.g., globals) are initialized at program start-up.
- If you don't initialize them, they automatically get **zero**.
- If you do initialize them, you need a **constant expression**

```
char globalC = 'a';           // Yes
int globalI = 15 + (39 % 3);   // Yes
int globalJ = globalI + 1;     // Nope
```

Auto Storage Class

- Storage for local variables is **automatically** allocated
 - When control enters their containing block
 - Maybe when the function starts, it's the compiler's choice.
 - These variables have the **auto** storage class
 - We'll also call them *local* or *stack* variables.
- Auto is even a keyword:
`auto int i = 5;`



Auto Variable Initialization

- If you don't initialize them ... you get whatever's left over in that part of stack memory.

```
for ( int i = 0; i < 100; i++ ) {  
    int a;  
    ...;  
}
```

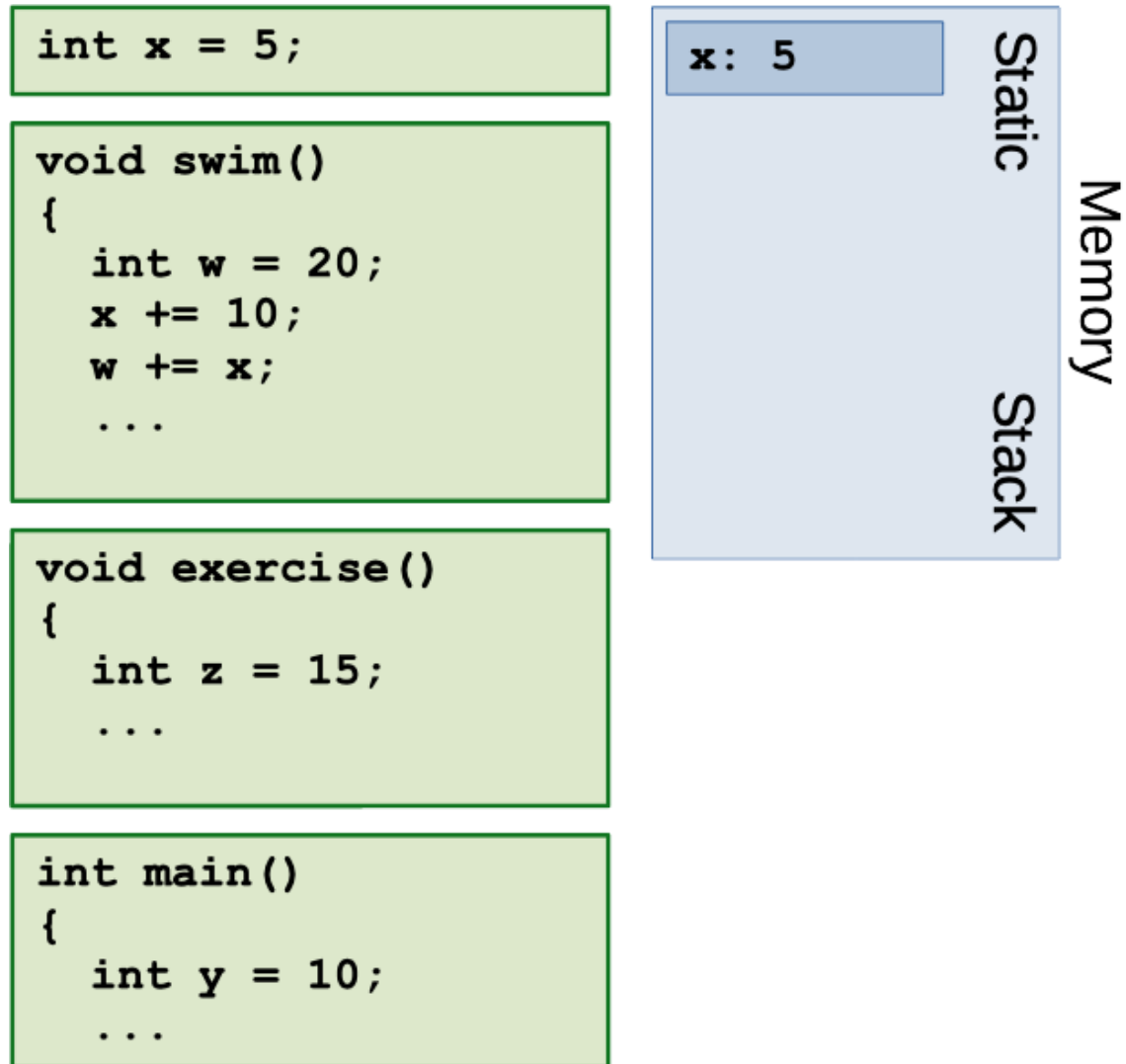
Who knows what value this will have. A common mistake.

- If you do initialize ... the initialization is evaluated each time control passes the declaration.

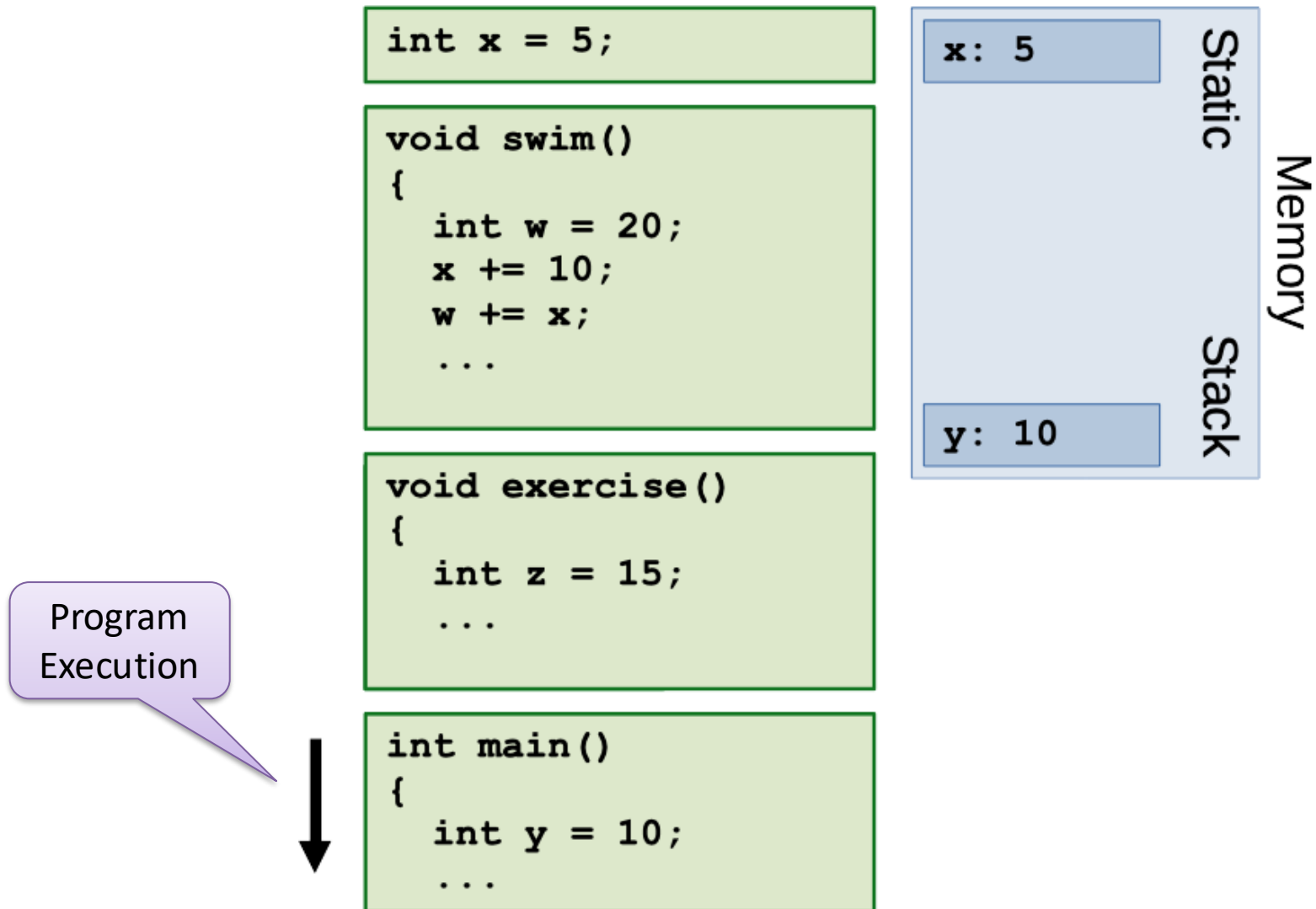
```
for ( int i = 0; i < 100; i++ ) {  
    int a = pow( 3.25, i ) + sqrt( i + 1 );  
    ...;  
}
```

This gets evaluated on every iteration.

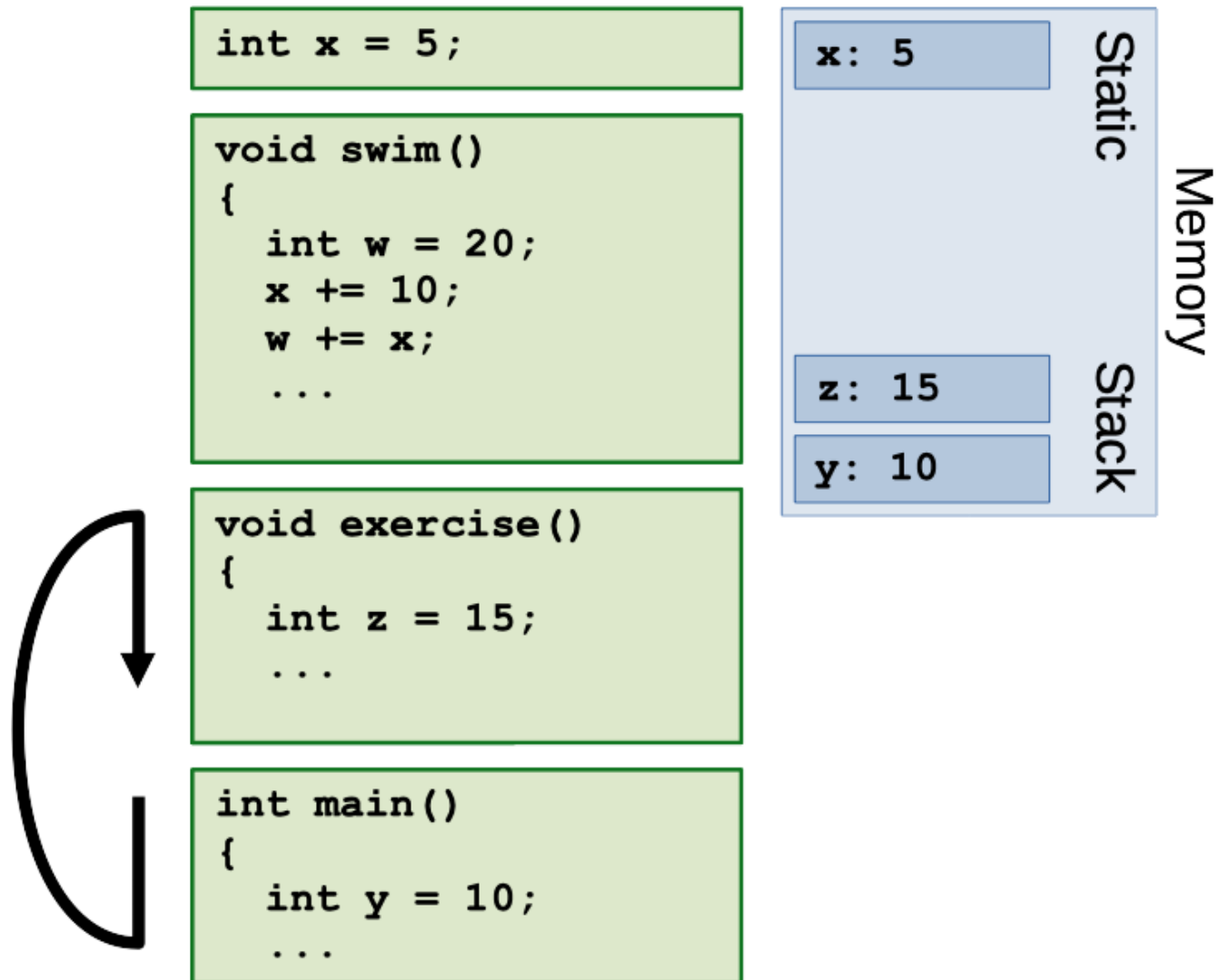
Variable Allocation/Initialization



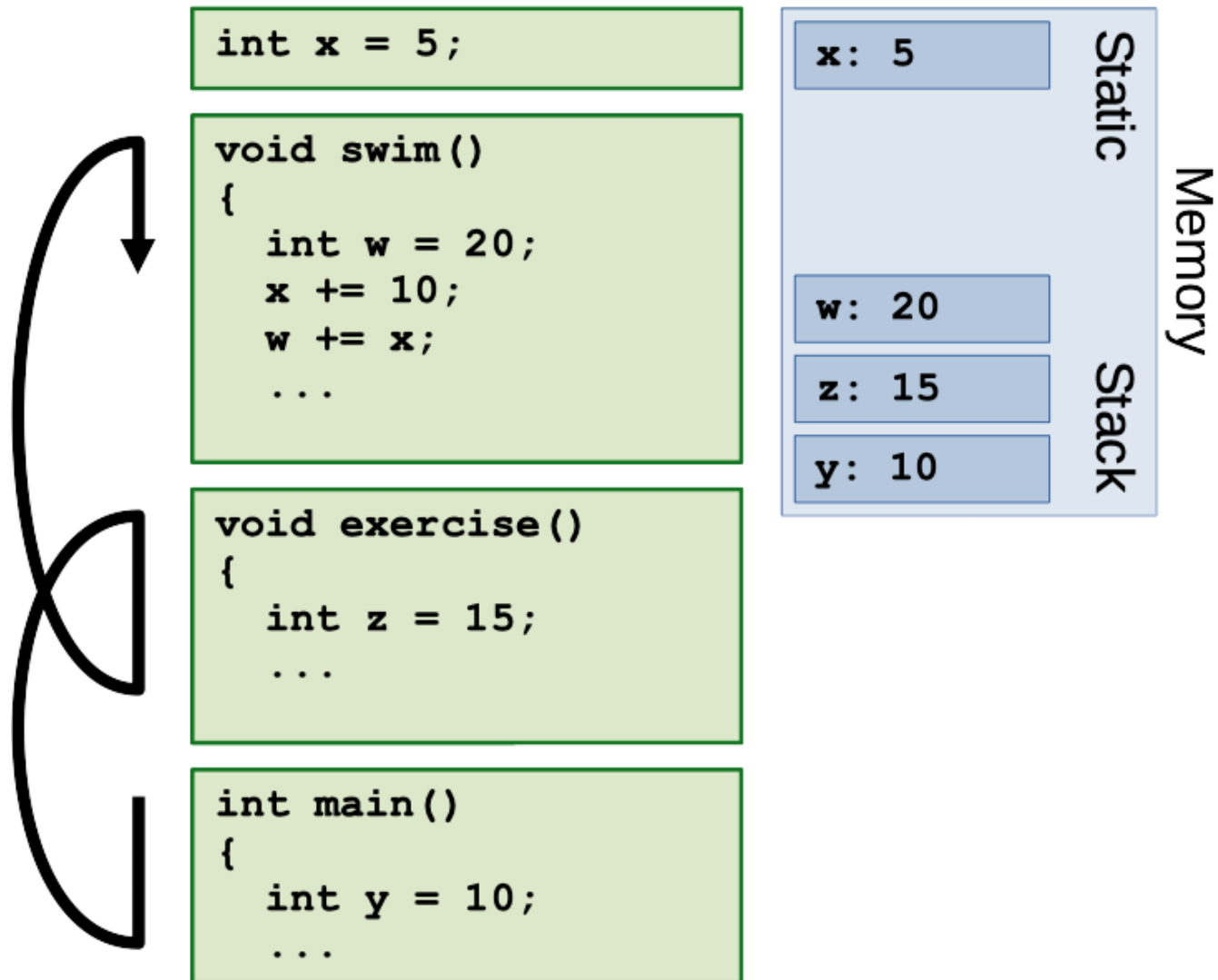
Variable Allocation/Initialization



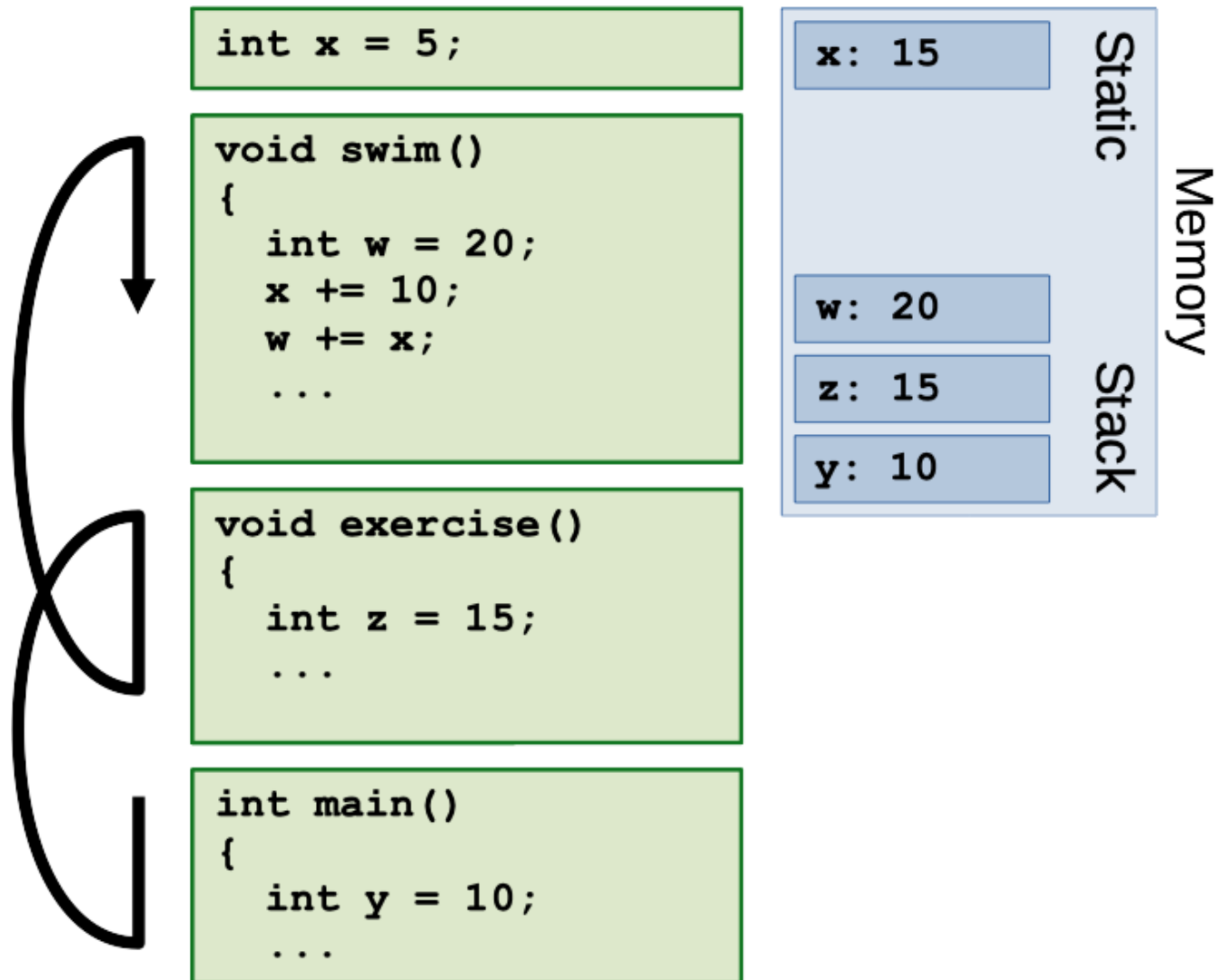
Variable Allocation/Initialization



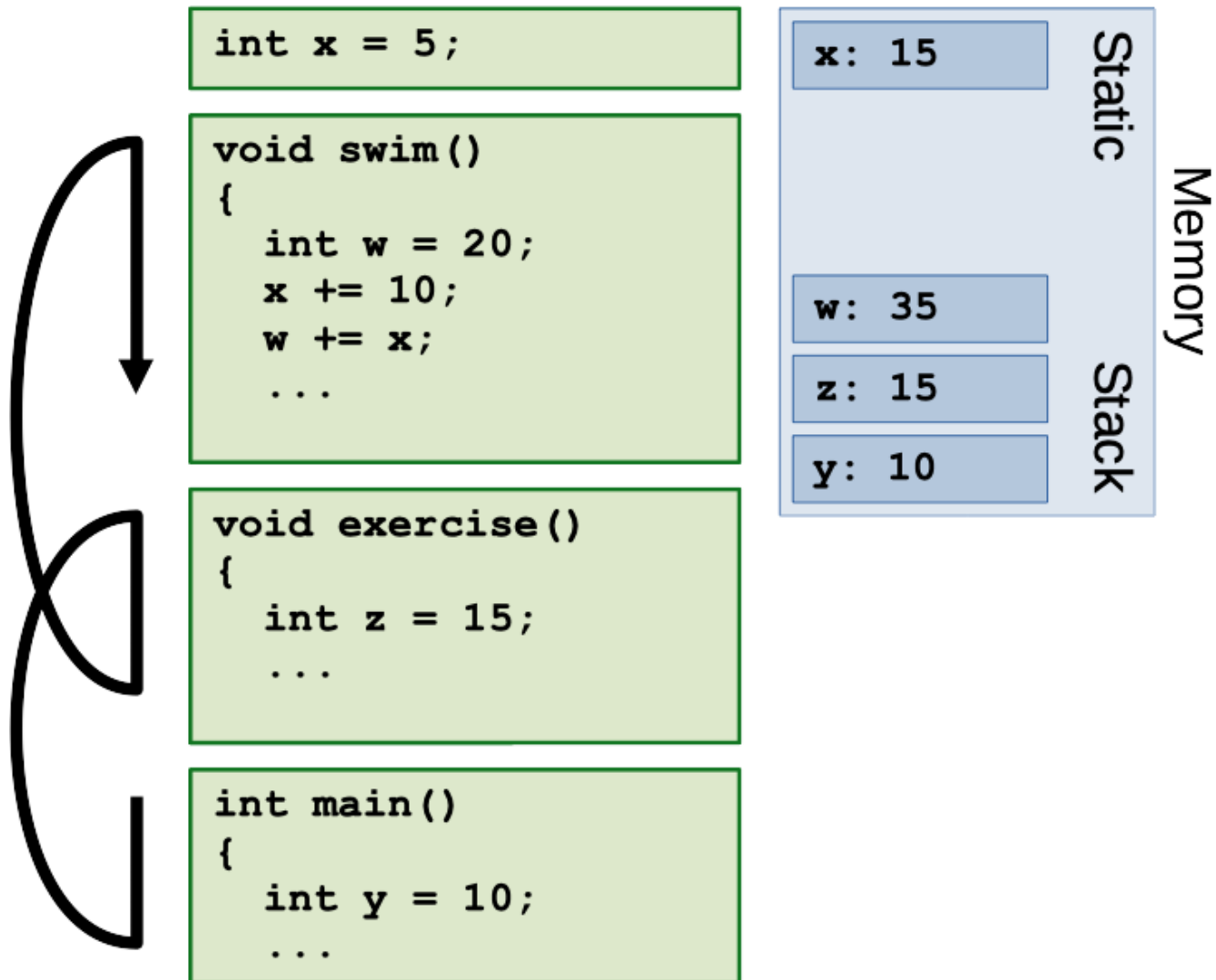
Variable Allocation/Initialization



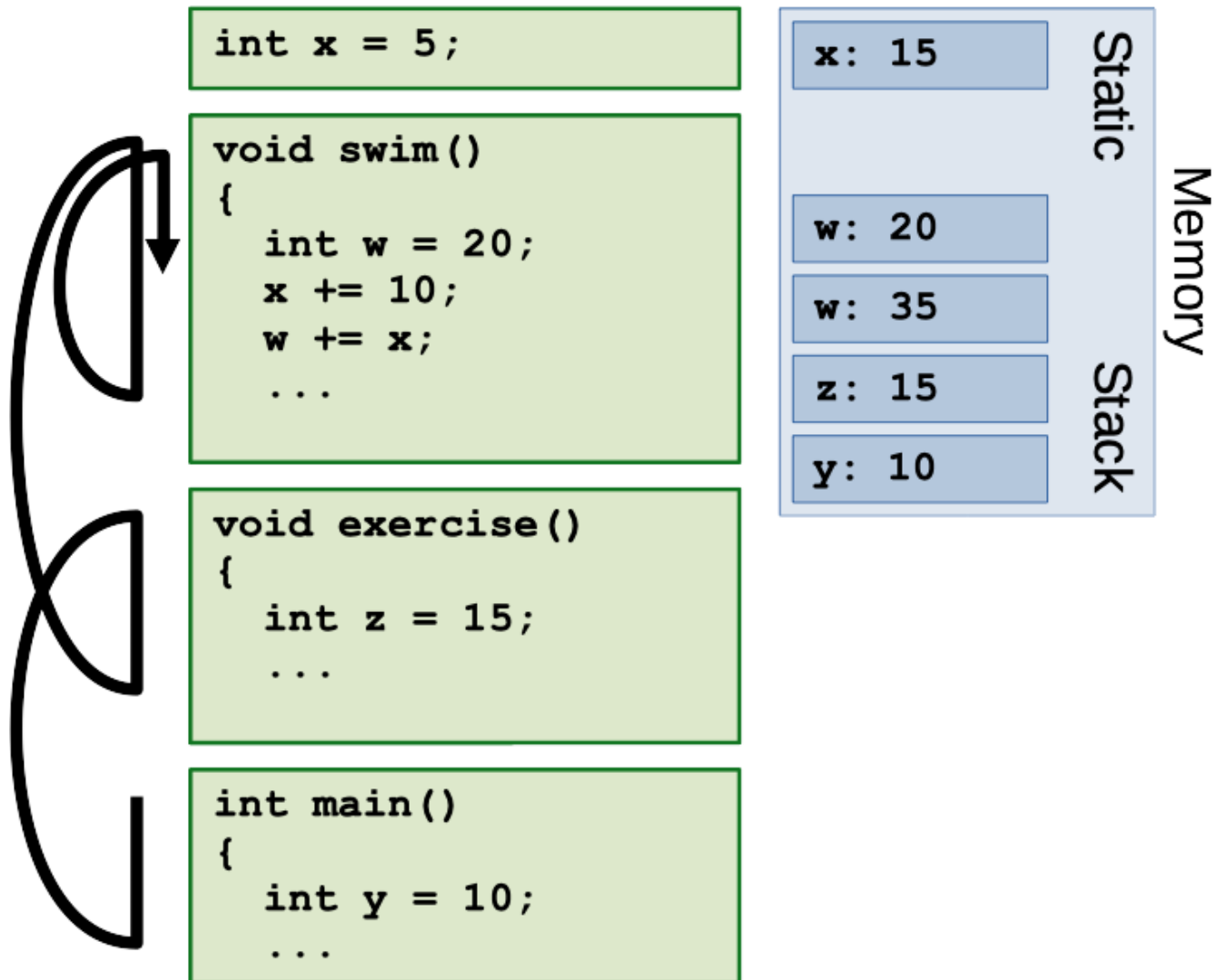
Variable Allocation/Initialization



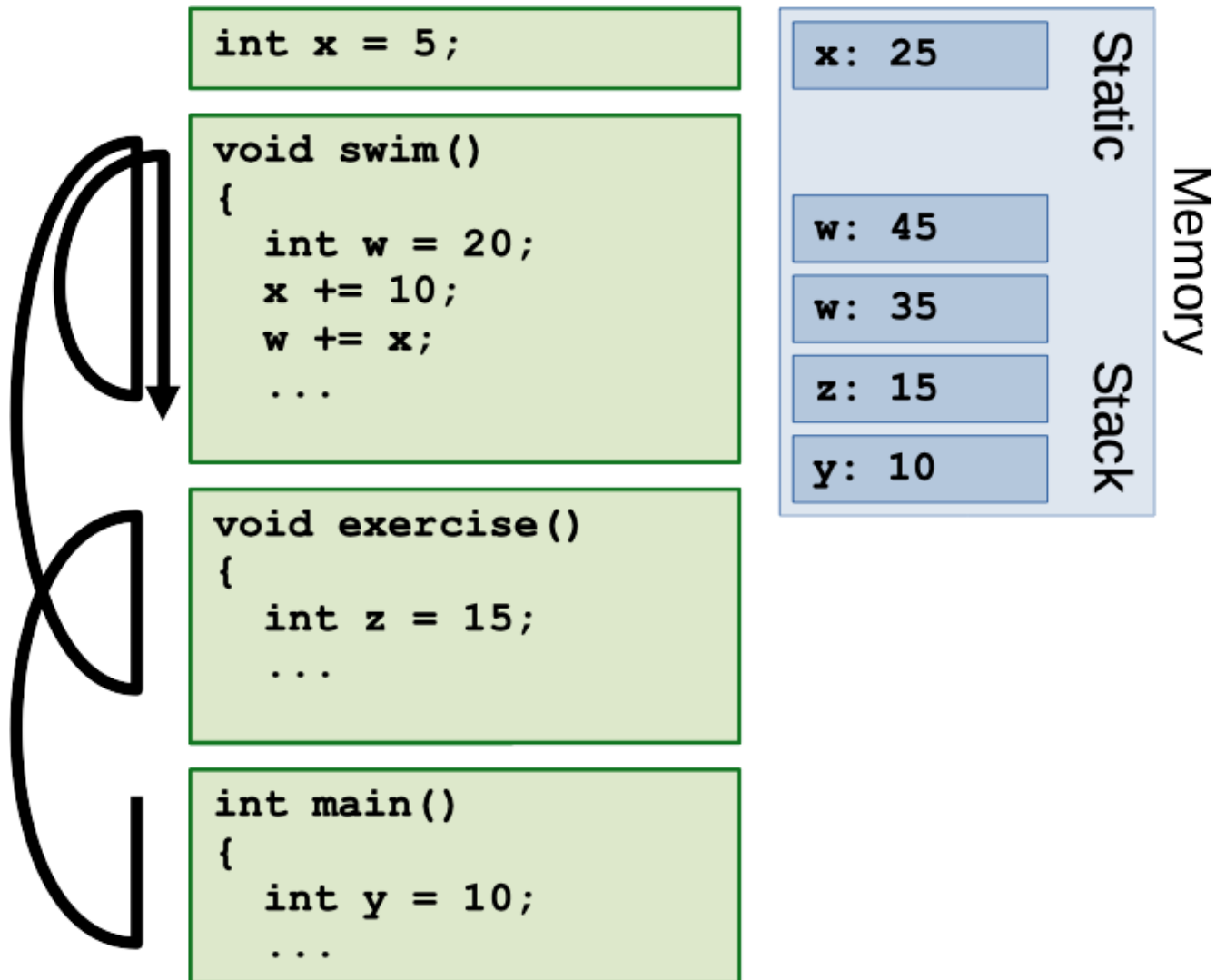
Variable Allocation/Initialization



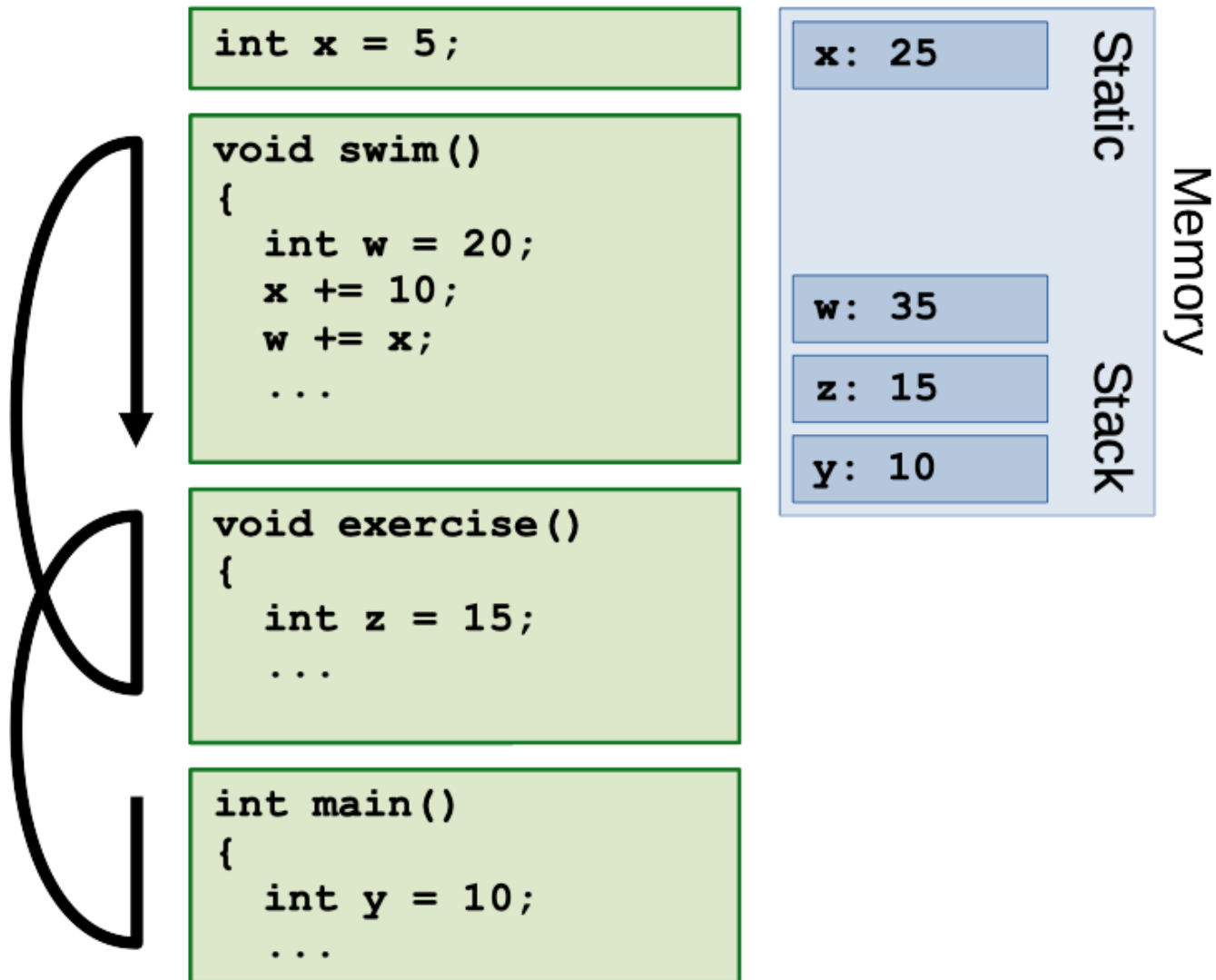
Variable Allocation/Initialization



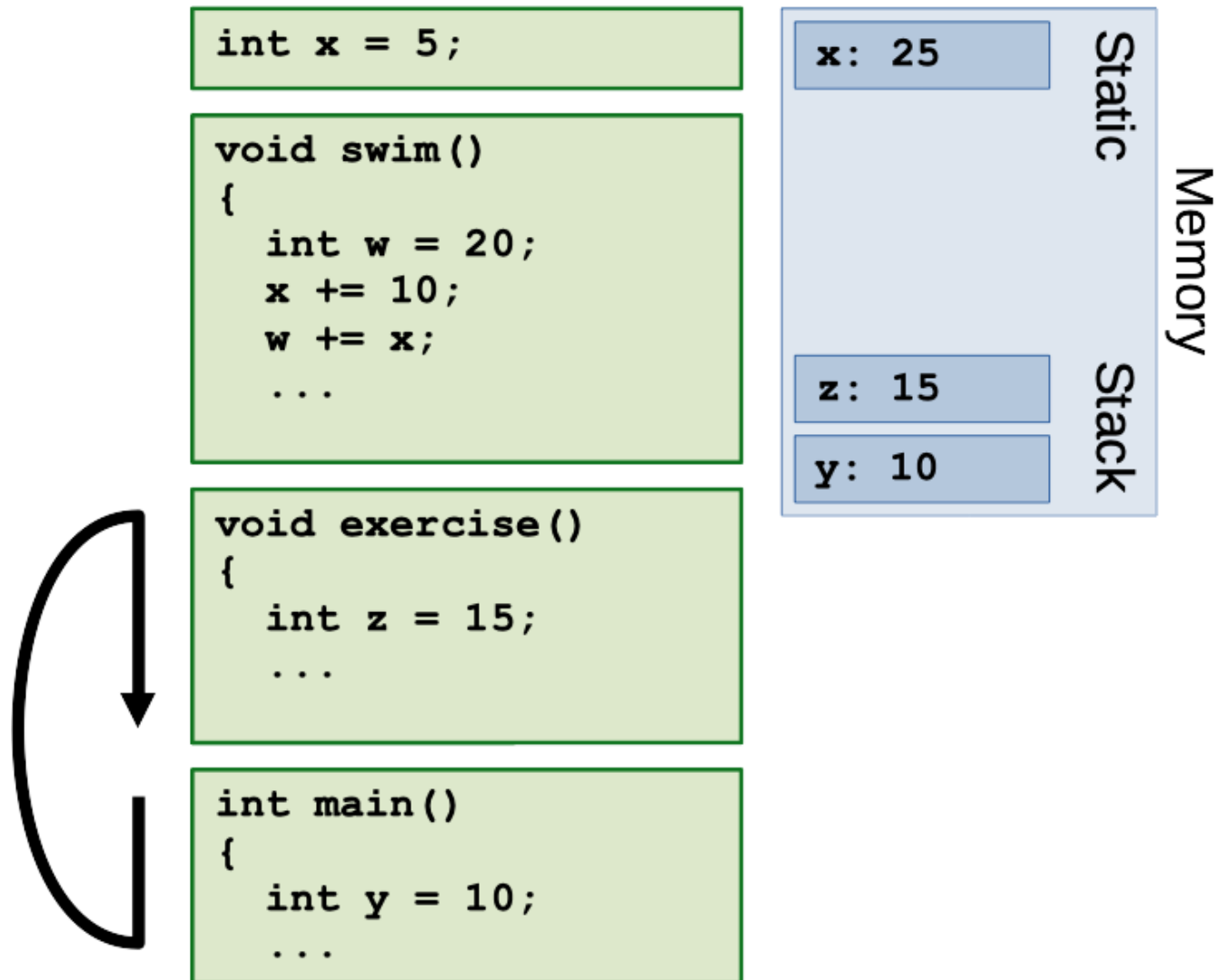
Variable Allocation/Initialization



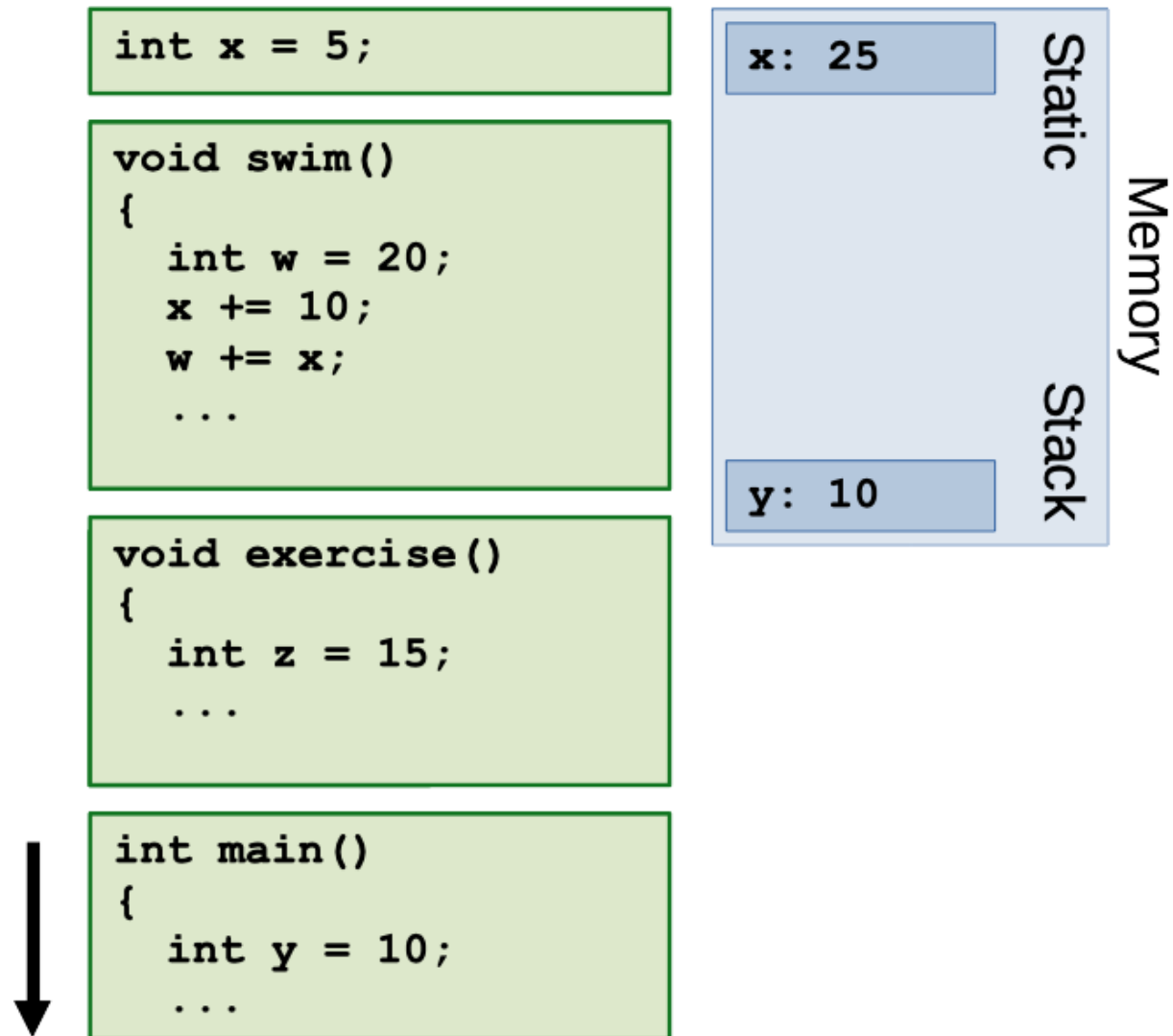
Variable Allocation/Initialization



Variable Allocation/Initialization



Variable Allocation/Initialization



Static Local Variables

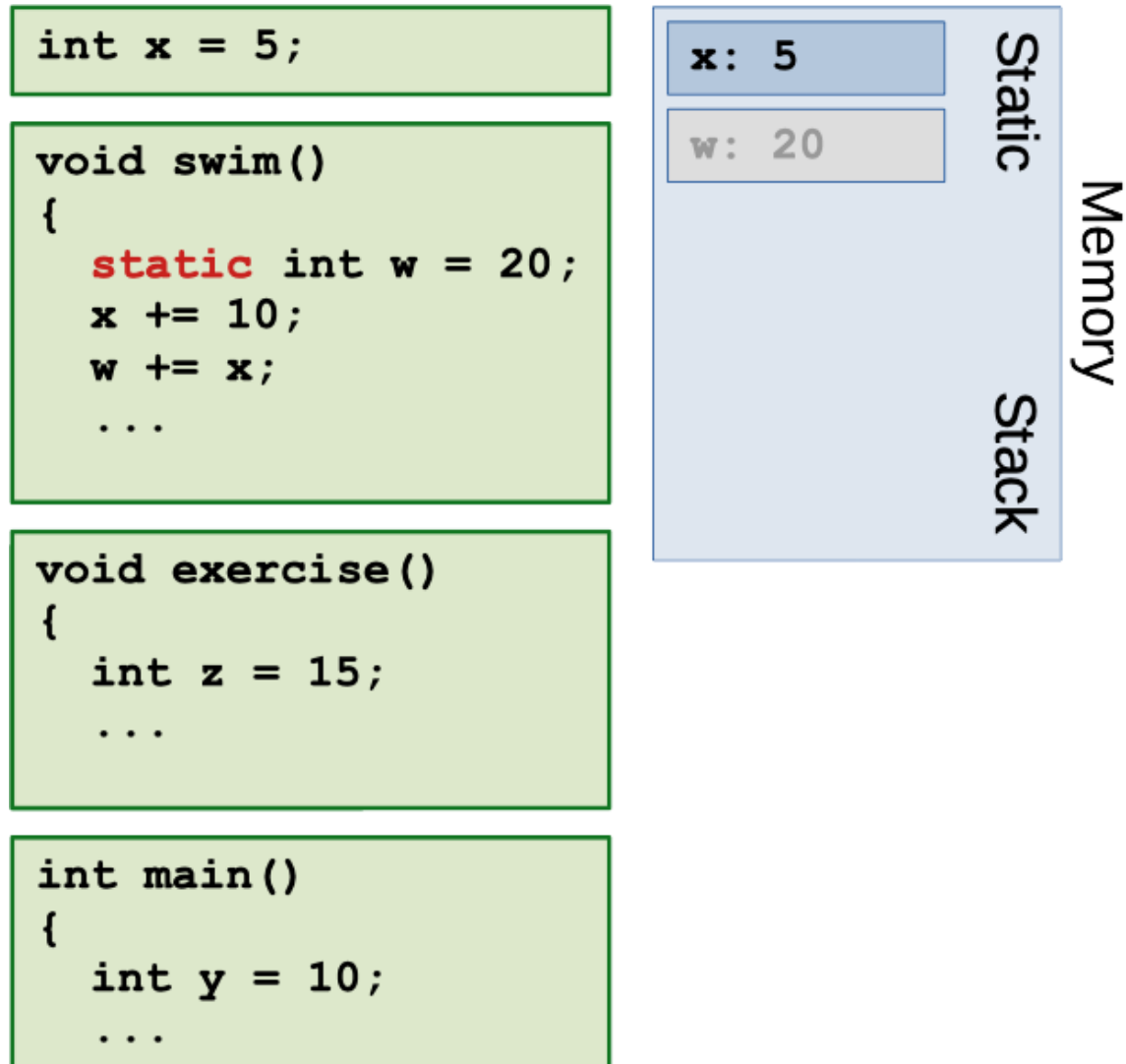
- Scope isn't the same as storage class.
 - You can have local variables that are statically allocated
 - How? Using the keyword `static`.

```
for ( int i = 0; i < 100; i++ ) {  
    static int a = 10 + EXTRA;  
    ...;  
}
```

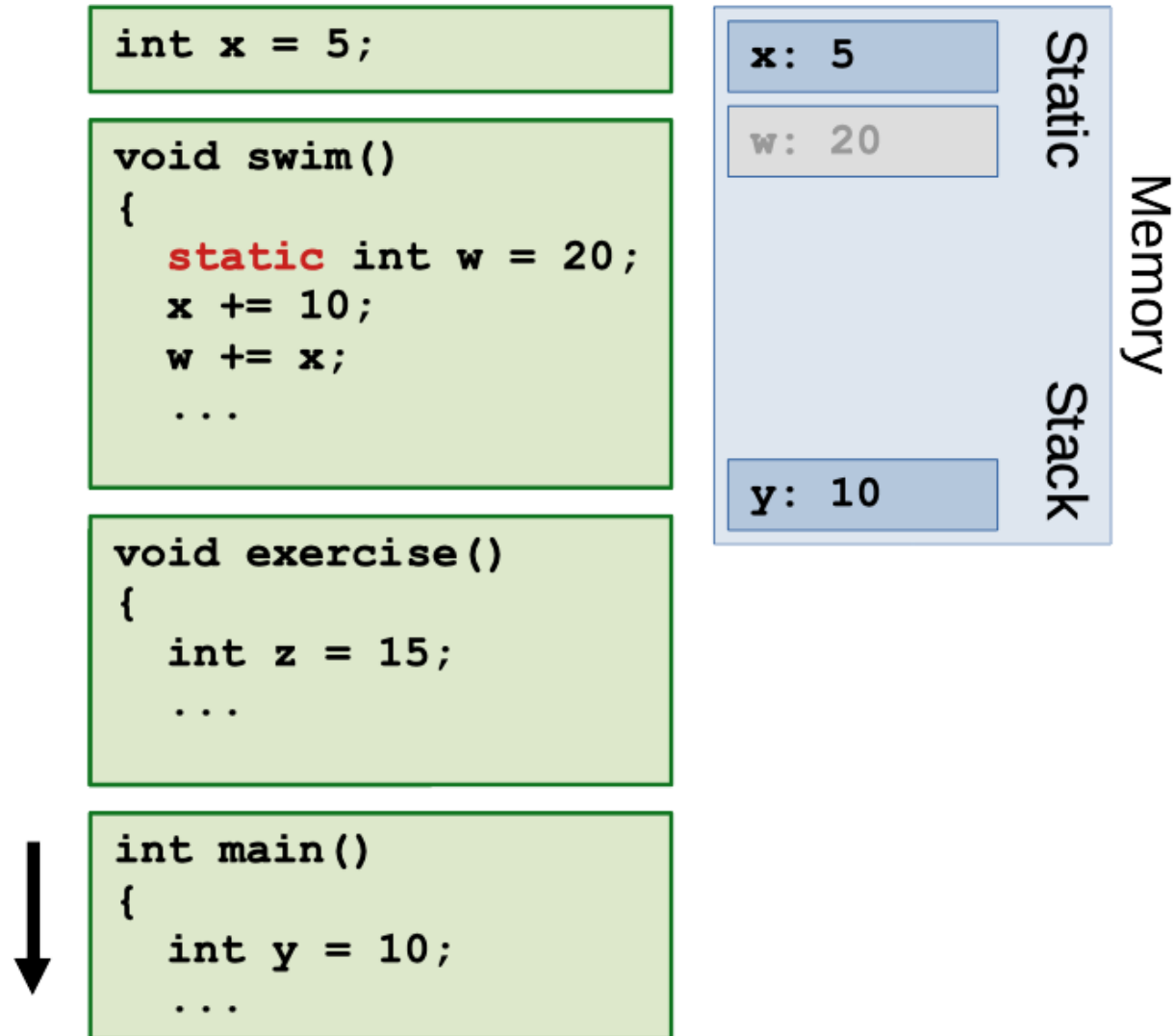
I just get created and initialized once.

- It's like a variable that has the lifetime of a global, but the scope of a stack variable.
- Like a global, requires a **constant initialization expression**.

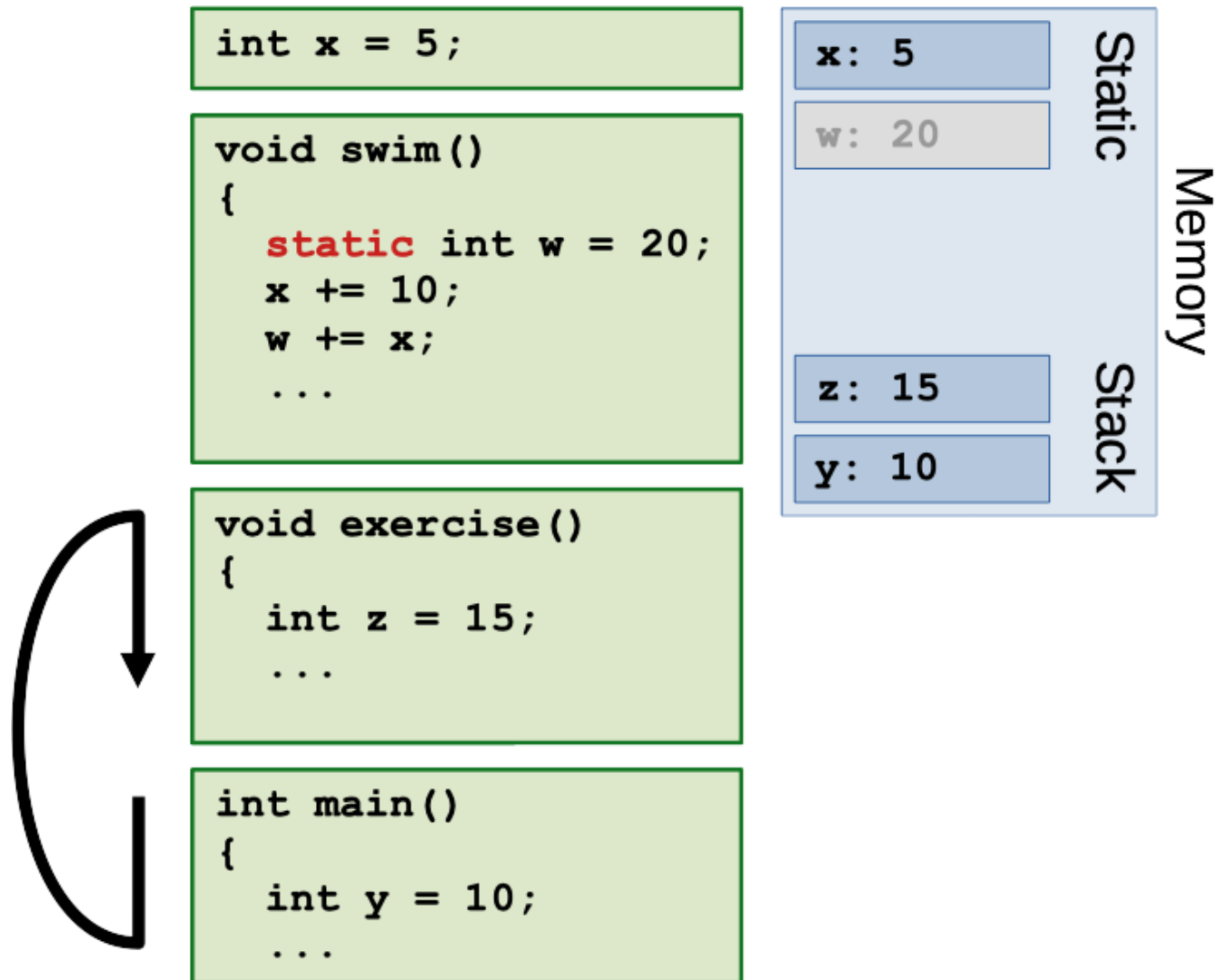
Variable Allocation/Initialization



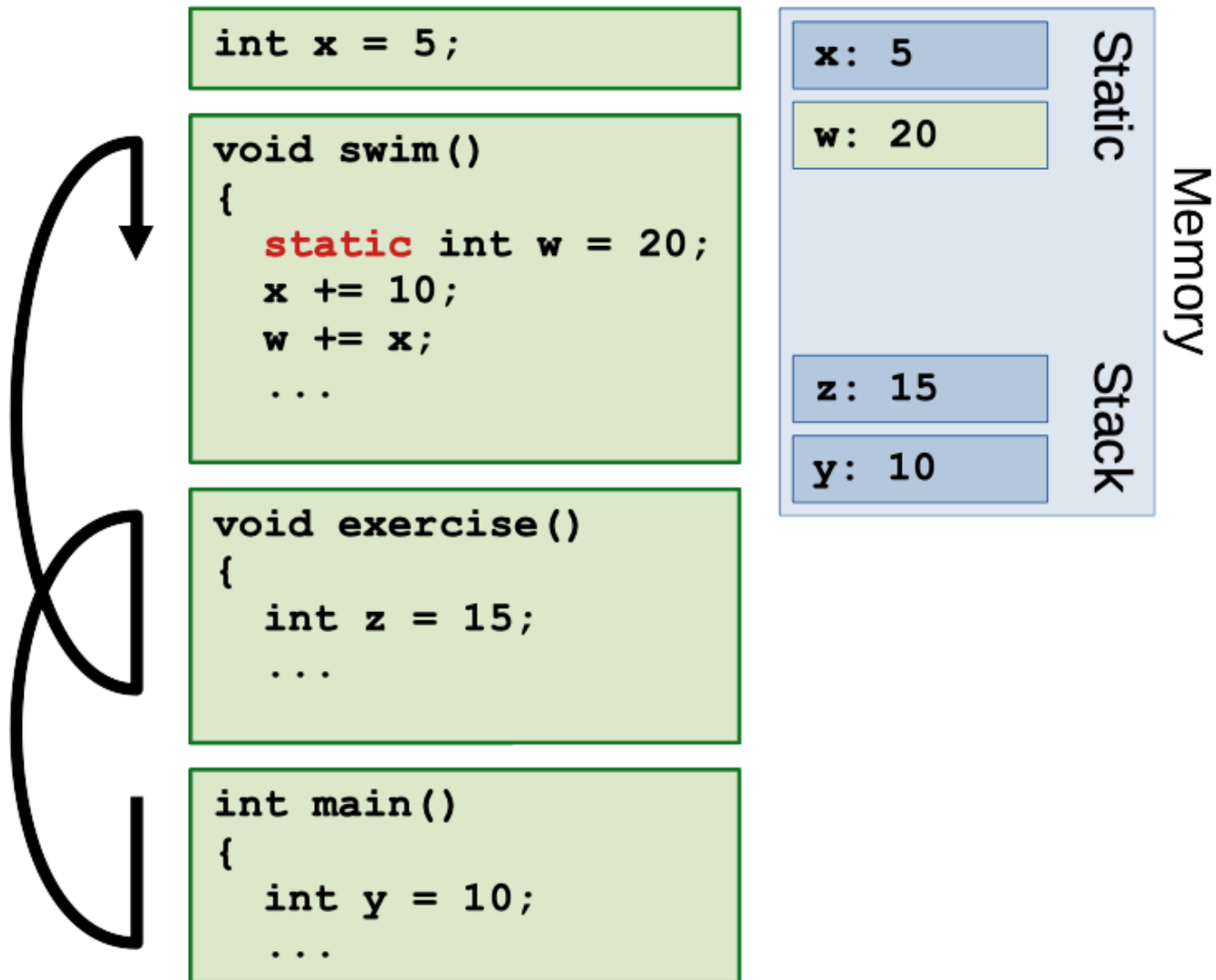
Variable Allocation/Initialization



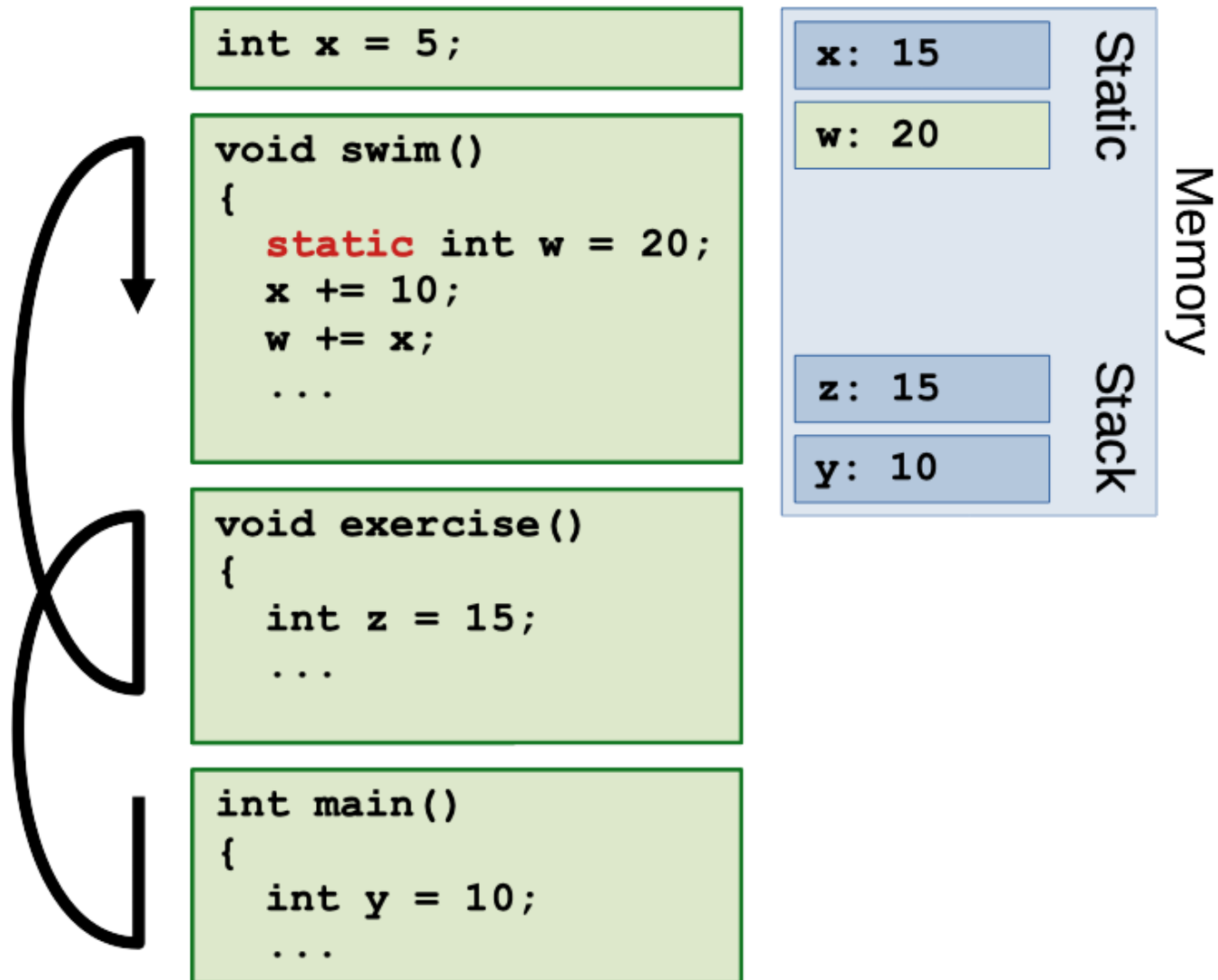
Variable Allocation/Initialization



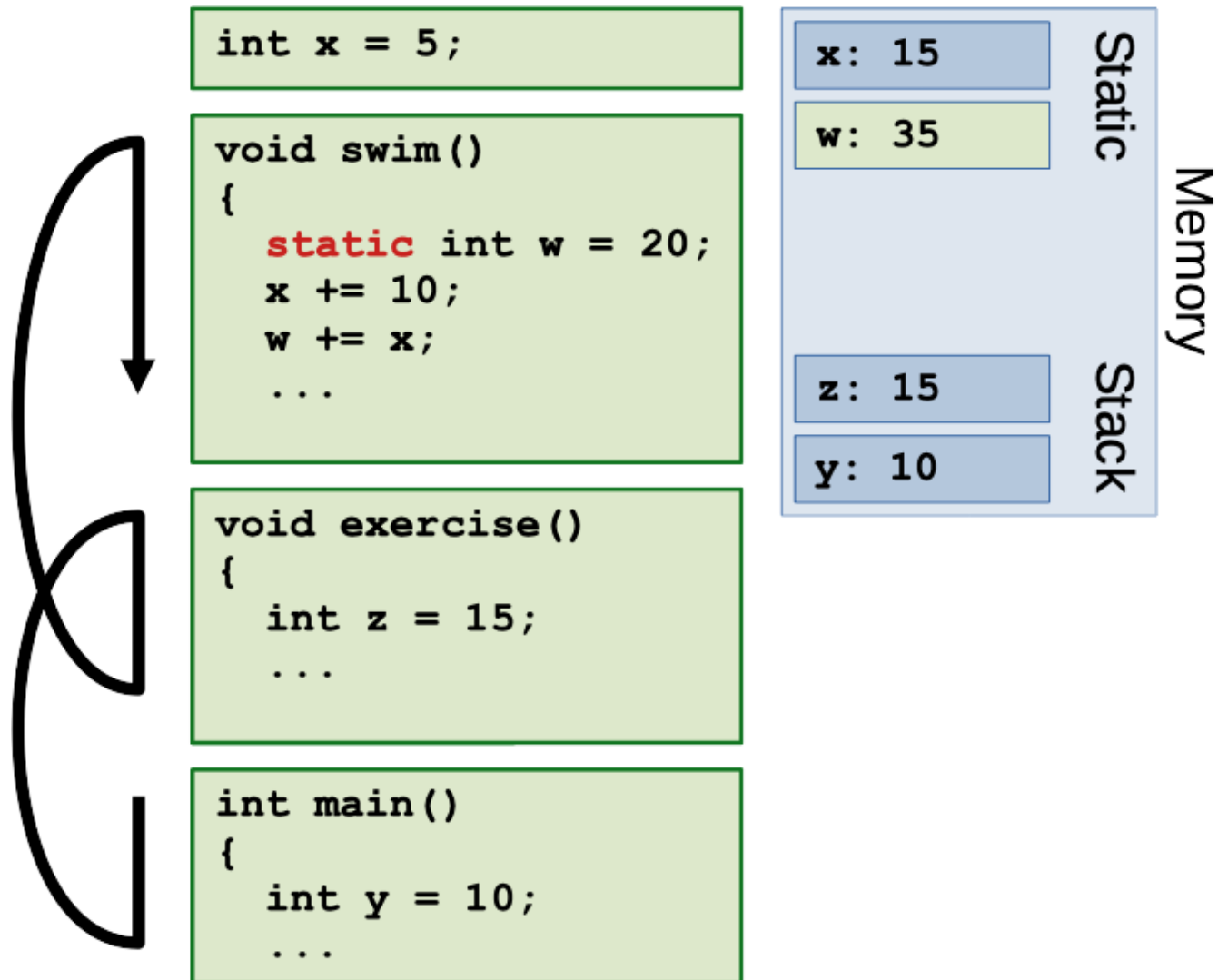
Variable Allocation/Initialization



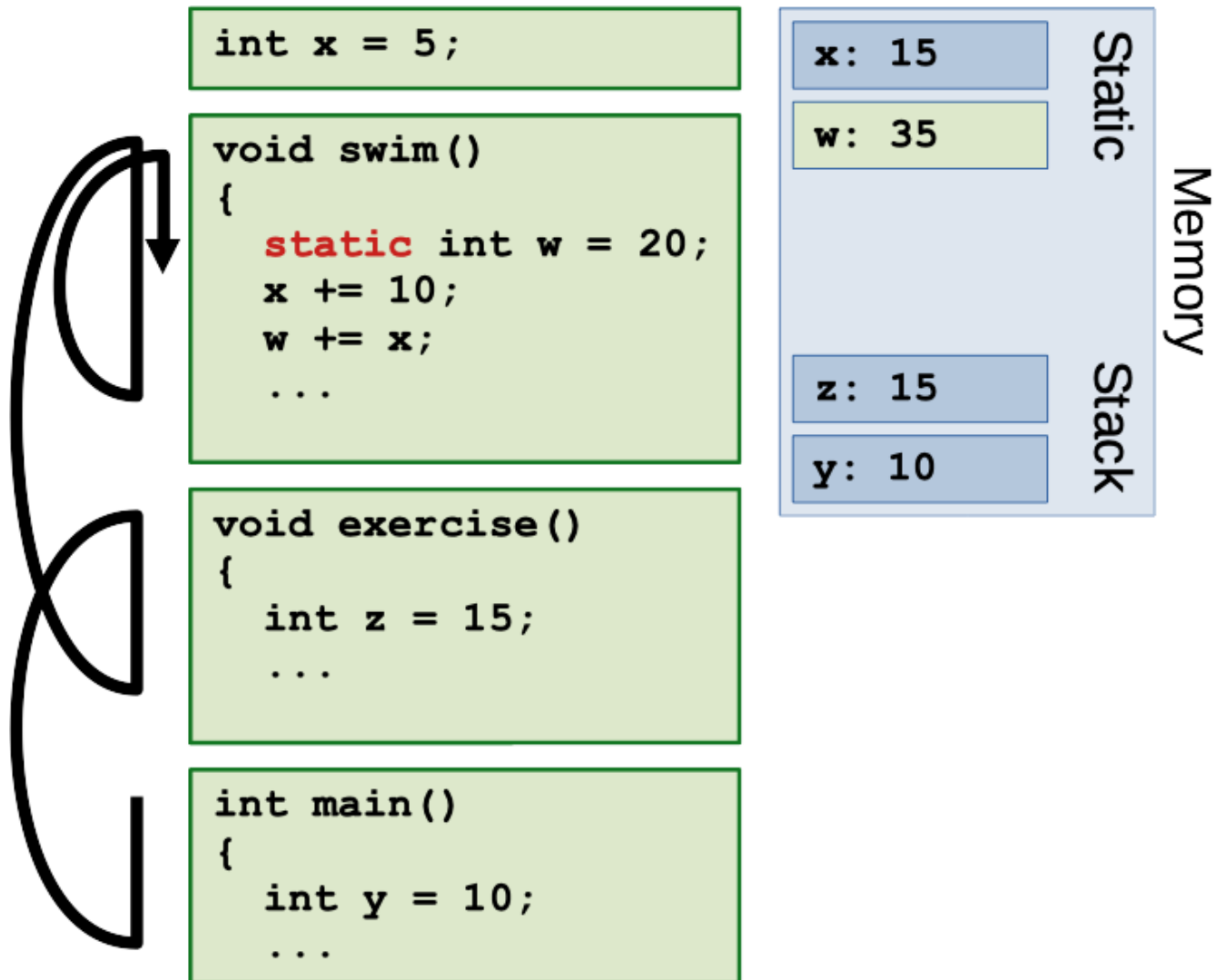
Variable Allocation/Initialization



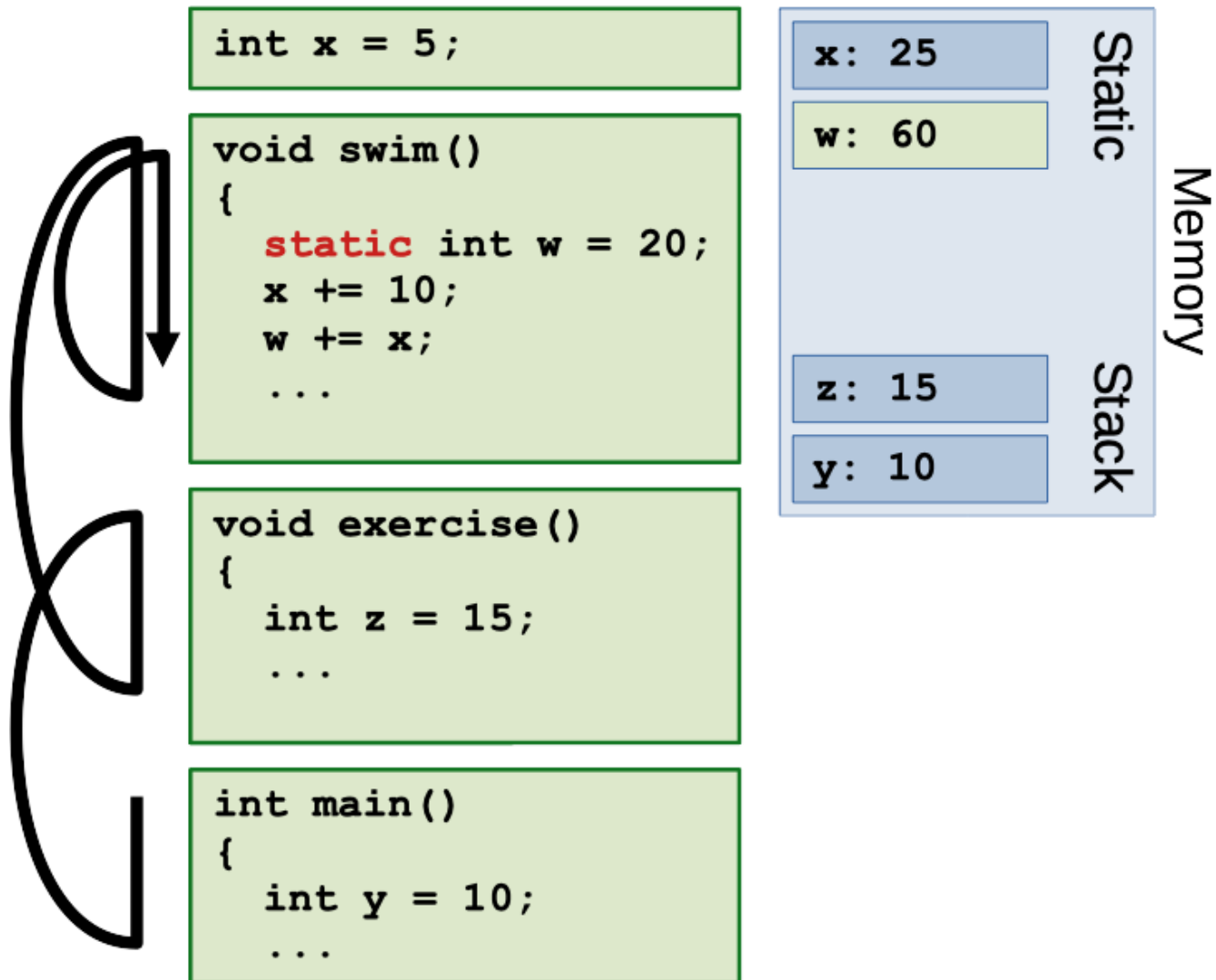
Variable Allocation/Initialization



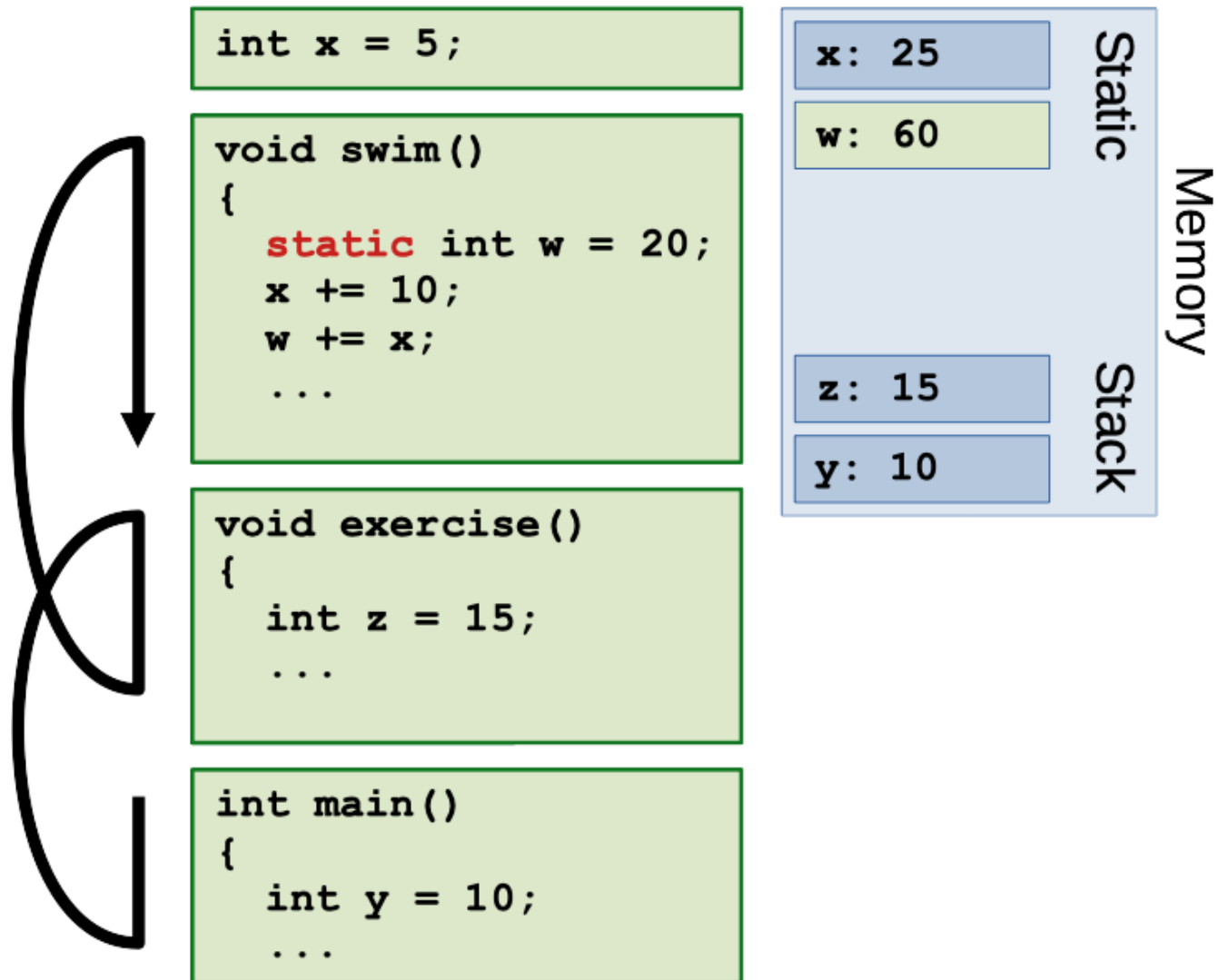
Variable Allocation/Initialization



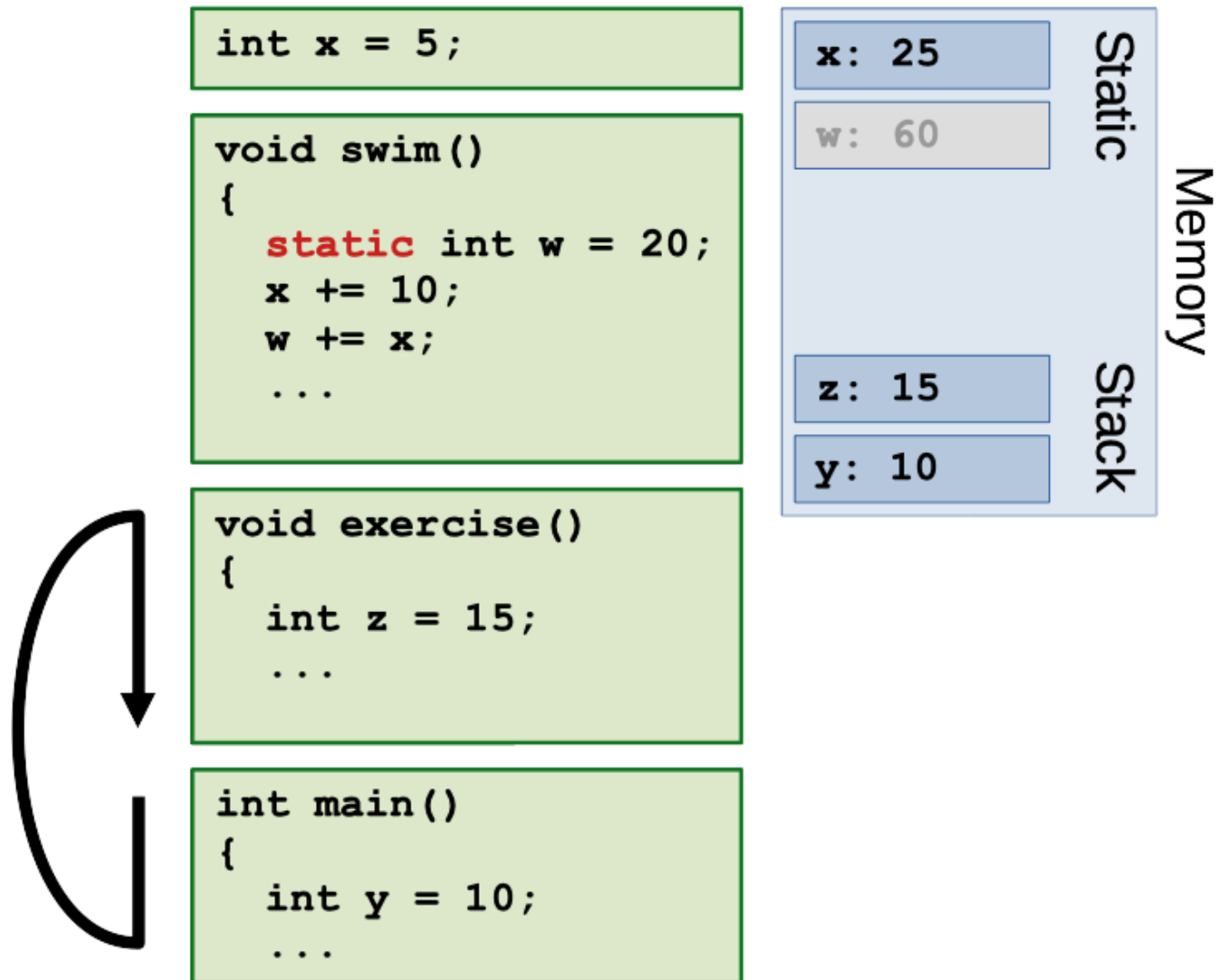
Variable Allocation/Initialization



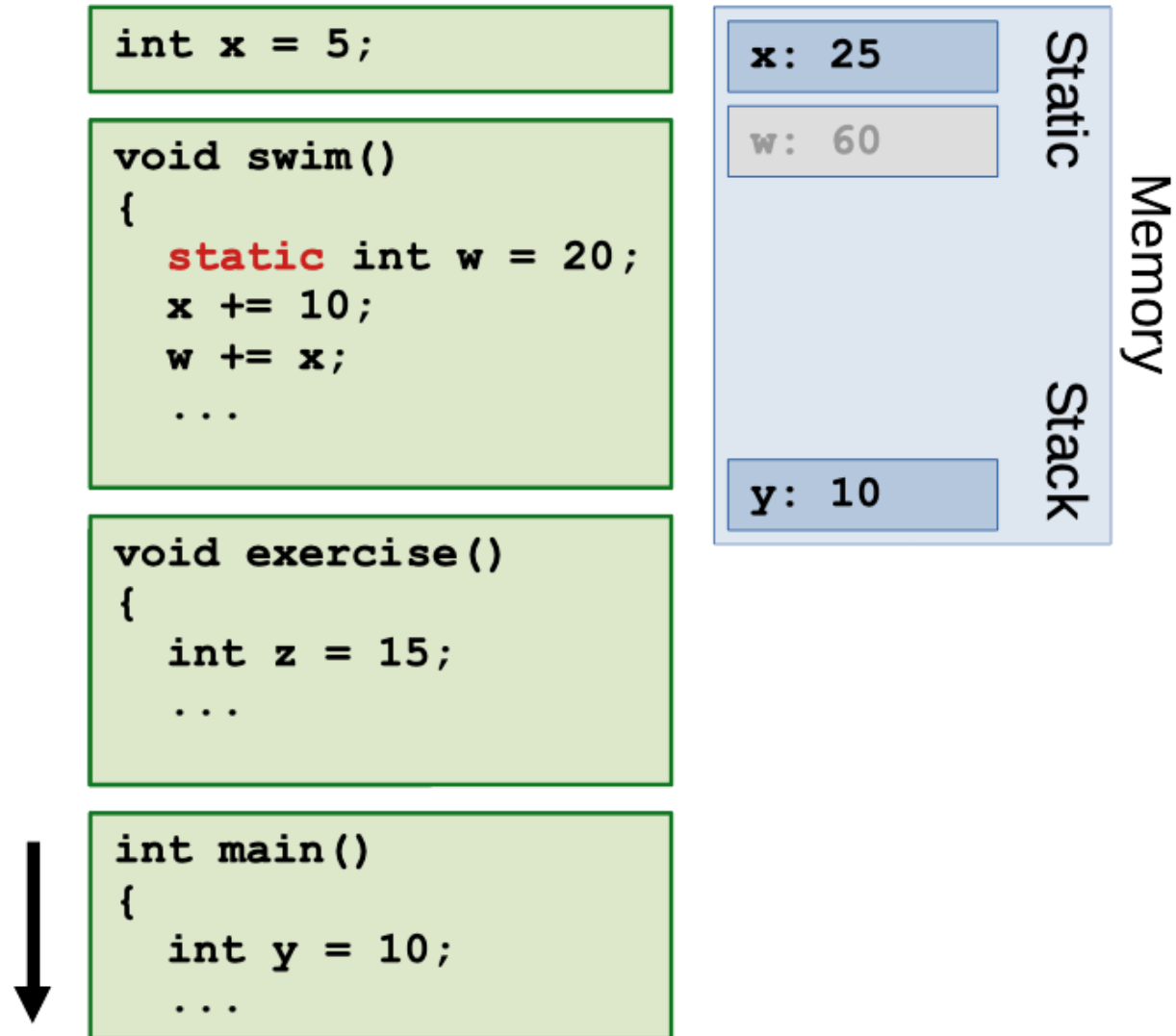
Variable Allocation/Initialization



Variable Allocation/Initialization



Variable Allocation/Initialization



Variable Initialization Summary

- Local variables
 - Initialized by re-evaluating their initialization expression each time they are created.
 - Or, not initialized at all if there's no initialization expression.
- Global variables
 - Initialized once at the start of execution via their constant initialization expression
 - Or initialized to zero if you don't supply an expression.
- Static local variables
 - Just like global

Designing with Functions

- While a Java program is a collection of cooperating objects
- ... a C program is a collection of cooperating functions.
- Functions are our best building block for a good design.
 - It's how we can share code across multiple parts of an application.
 - It's how we re-use code across multiple projects.
 - A library is mostly a collection of functions we can call.

Function Parameters

- Functions can take any number of parameters
- Including no parameters

– Like

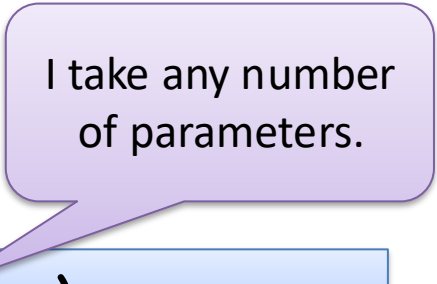
```
void abort( void )
```

This says “I don’t take any parameters”.

A function to immediately exit, unsuccessfully.

Parameter Matching

- To call a function, you need to provide
 - The right number of actual parameters
 - ... and they have to be convert-able to the formal-parameter types
- You can define functions that take any number of parameters of various types.
 - We have a ... notation for this.
 - ... more on this later.



I take any number of parameters.

```
void printFloats( int n, ... );
```

Function Return Values

- A void return type says the function doesn't return anything.

```
void printFloat( float x );
```

- Or, a function can return a value of (just about) any type.
- It sure would be nice to be able to return more than one value.
 - But, as in Java, each function has one precious return slot.
 - Soon, we'll learn a few tricks to get around that.

Parameter Conversion

- C will implicitly convert *actual parameters*
- ... to the *formal parameter* types

```
int expunge( float x, long y )  
{  
    ...  
}
```

I'm a formal parameter, x.

These will convert to float and long to make the call.

```
int a = 7;  
char b = 'm';  
expunge( a, b );
```

I'm an actual parameter, 7.

Parameter Conversion

- This is why the compiler wants to know about a function before it gets called.
 - It needs to know what to convert the parameters to.

```
int a = 7;  
char b = 'm';  
expunge( a, b );
```

I guess maybe this function takes two ints?

Oops. I was wrong. Too late to fix it now.

```
int expunge( float x, long y )  
{  
    ...  
}
```

Knowing a Function's Type

- The compiler can learn about a function's type (return and parameter types) without seeing the whole function definition.

```
int expunge( float x, long y )  
{  
    ...  
}
```

I'm a
definition.

- This is done with a *function prototype*

```
int expunge( float x, long y );
```

I'm just a
prototype.

Types in Prototypes

- A prototype just needs the typing information.

```
int expunge( float, long );
```

- But, you can include parameter names if you want.

```
int expunge( float x, long y );
```

- Having the names can help with documentation.

Definition vs Declaration

- This demonstrates the difference between a definition and a declaration.
- *Definition* : here's some thing, allocate space or write code for it Mr. Compiler
 - Like a function definition.
- *Declaration* : there's something like this out there, but it's defined elsewhere.
 - You may see me trying to use it, so don't act surprised Mr. Compiler.
 - Like a function prototype.

Code Organization

- With prototypes, we can define our functions in any order.
- As long as we prototype them before they're used.

There's a function like this.

```
int expunge( float x, long y );
```

OK. I've heard of this function before.

```
int a = 7;  
char b = 'm';  
expunge( a, b );
```

OK. Just like I expected.

```
int expunge( float x, long y )  
{  
    ...  
}
```

Extern Variables

- That's what the `extern` keyword is for
 - It tells the compiler about a something that's defined elsewhere.
 - It lets us describe a global variable without allocating space for it.
 - So, it lets us declare a variable without defining it.

```
int x;
```

I'm a declaration **and** a definition.

```
extern int x;
```

I'm just a declaration.

Extern and Prototypes

- This is the same kind of thing a prototype does.
 - It tells the compiler about something defined elsewhere (or later).
- In fact, you can use the keyword `extern` with a prototype

I'm a declaration **and** a definition.

```
void f( int a ) {  
    ...  
}
```

I'm just a declaration.

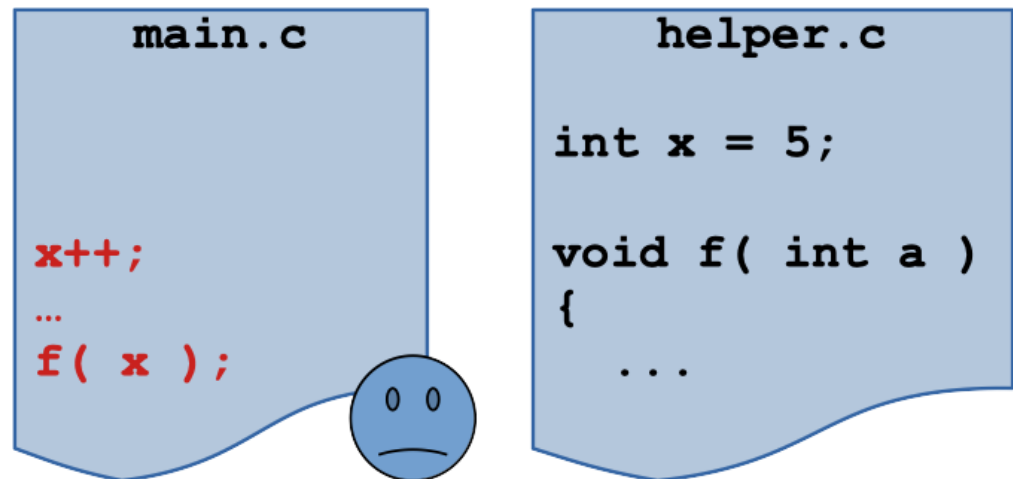
```
extern void f( int a );
```

I'm optional.

- But, `extern` doesn't change anything on a prototype, so most people don't use it here.

Multi-File Programs

- We can make **functions** and **global variables** that are **visible to multiple source files**.
- But, the compiler looks at each source file as an individual ***compilation unit***.
 - it won't let us use symbols it has never heard of.



Using Extern Declarations

- We can use an extern variable declarations and prototypes to access symbols (variables and functions) defined elsewhere.
 - This makes the compiler happy when it sees us use them.
 - Then, the linker connects each use with its memory location.

main.c

```
extern int x;  
void f( int );  
  
x++;  
f( x );
```



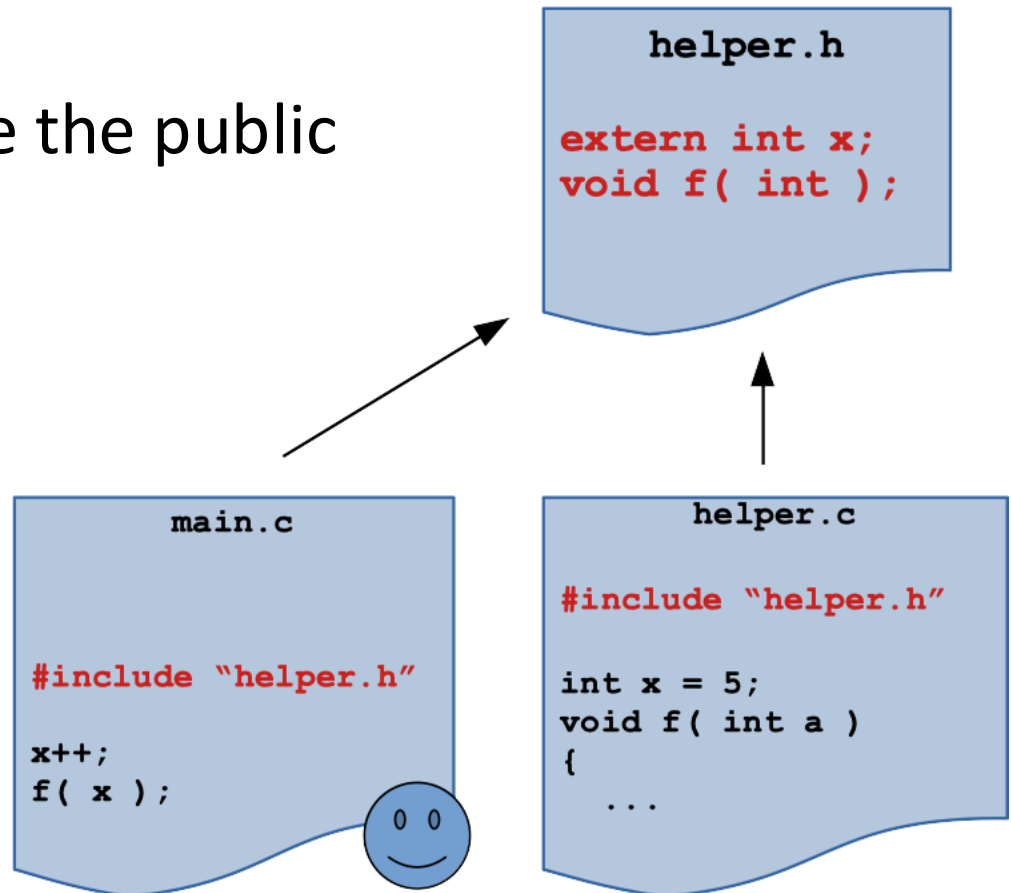
helper.c

```
int x = 5;  
  
void f( int a )  
{  
    ...  
}
```

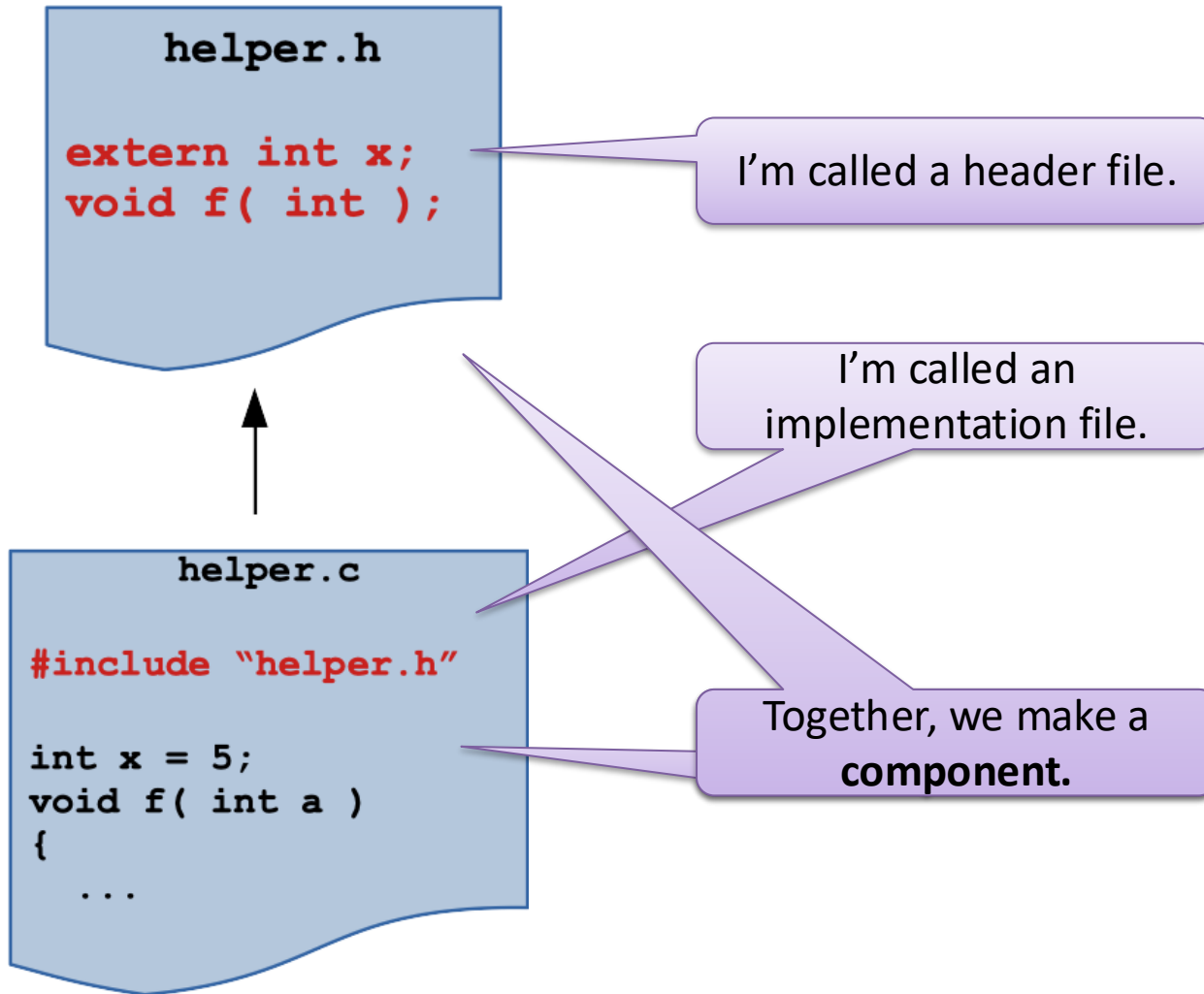
I'm still not
completely happy.

Using Headers

- Really, this the right job for a **header file**.
 - It should advertise the public interface for an **implementation file**.

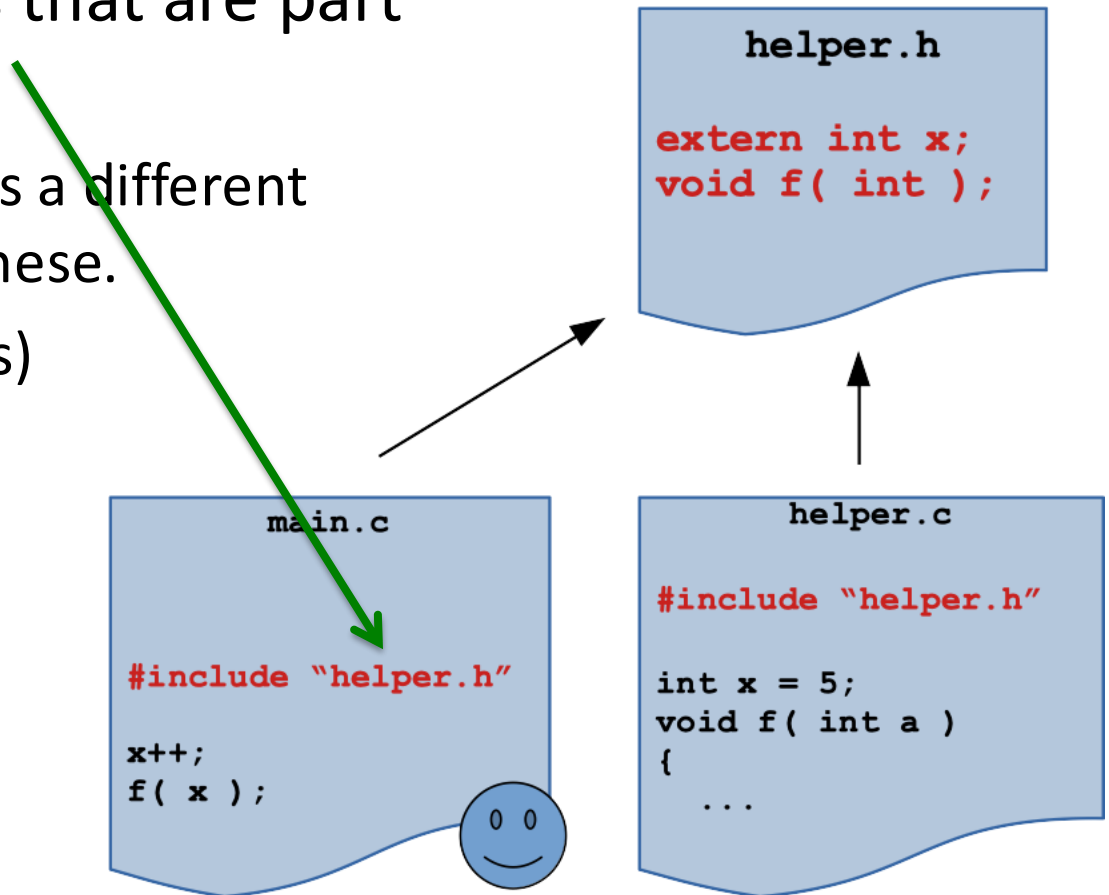


Components



Things to Notice

- We use double quotes when including headers that are part of our project.
 - The compiler uses a different search path for these.
 - (vs angle brackets)



Things to Notice

- It's a good practice to include your own header file first.
 - You may not actually need it.
 - ... but it makes sure your header compiles cleanly.
 - ... and its declarations always match what you're defining.

helper.h

```
extern int x;  
void f( int );
```

helper.c

```
#include "helper.h"  
  
int x = 5;  
void f( int a )  
{  
    ...  
}
```

Keeping Things Private

- There's another use of the `static` keyword.
 - For global variables, it marks them as invisible to the linker.
 - This works for functions also.
- We say it gives these symbols *internal linkage*
 - Good for symbols private to one component.
 - Like a private static field in Java.

main.c

```
extern int x;  
x++;  
  
void f( int );  
f( );
```



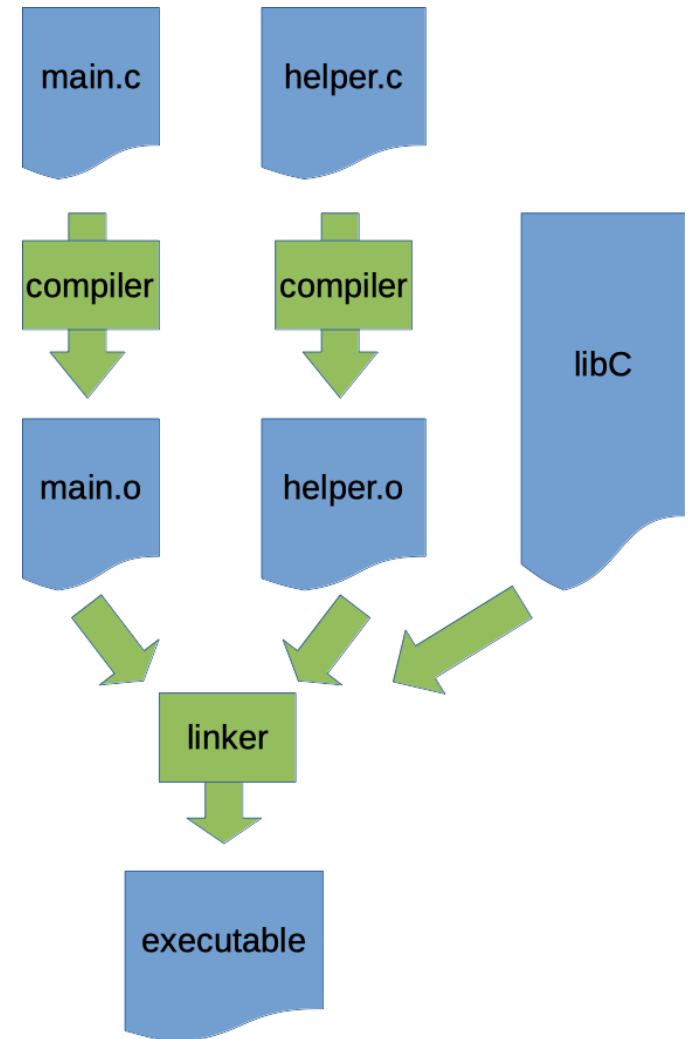
helper.c

```
static int x = 5;  
  
static void f( int a ) {  
    ...;  
}
```



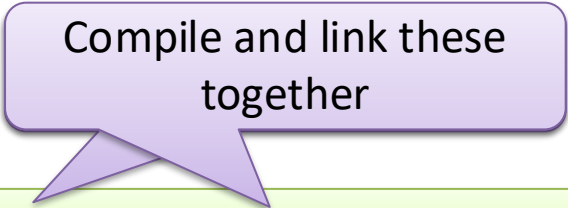
Building a Program

- Building a program requires two steps.
 - **Compiling** each implementation file to an **object file**.
 - **Linking** all the objects together into a single **address space**.
- The linker hooks up uses of symbols with their definitions in other components.
- Even if we only have one component, we still need to link with any libraries we use.



Compiling and Linking

- gcc can compile and link everything with one command.



Compile and link these together

```
$ gcc -Wall -std=c99 main.c helper.c
```

- This is an easy way to build a multi-file program ... but it's not very efficient.
- Mistakes in a header file or the gcc command can produce new types of errors ...

Compile-Time Errors

- The compiler will complain if it sees you using a symbol it's never heard of.

```
...  
f( x );  
...
```

This is a complaint
from the compiler.

```
eos$ gcc -Wall -std=c99 program.c  
program.c: ... warning: implicit declaration of function 'f' ...
```

- Maybe you forgot to include a header you need.
- Or, you forgot a prototype or extern variable declaration in a header.

Link-Time Errors

- With a prototype or an extern variable declaration, the compiler won't complain.
- But, the linker will if it can't find a definition for the function.

```
...  
f( x );  
...
```

This is a complaint
from the linker.

```
eos$ gcc -Wall -std=c99 program.c  
test.c:...: undefined reference to `f'
```

- Maybe you forgot to compile/link with one of the implementation files.